



Cloth Self Collision with Predictive Contacts

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Physics Engineer
EA Frostbite

No Mathematics Contained herein!

Get the technical report:

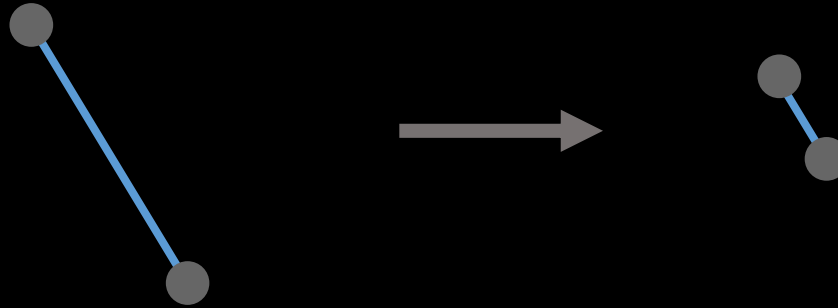
[https://www.ea.com/frostbite/news/
cloth-self-collision-with-predictive-contacts](https://www.ea.com/frostbite/news/cloth-self-collision-with-predictive-contacts)

Self Collision: Huh?



Simulating Cloth: How

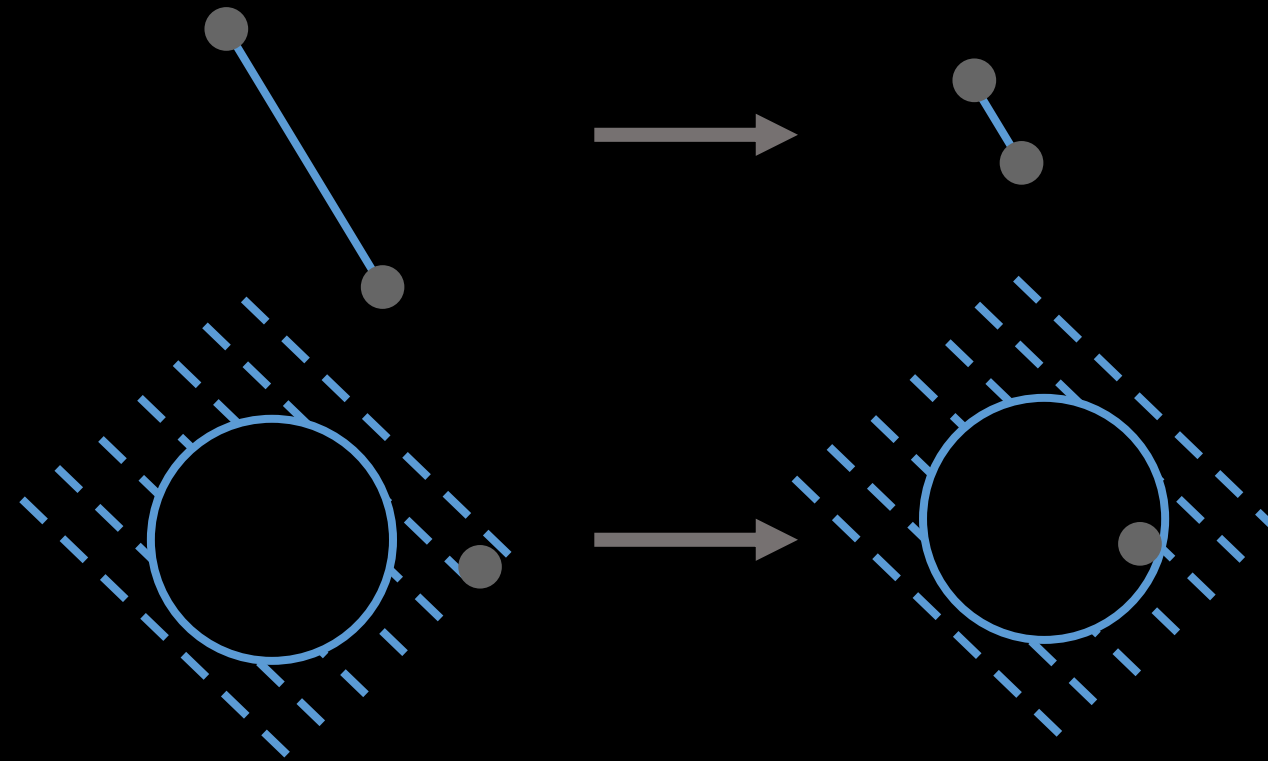
Length Constraints



Simulating Cloth: How

Length Constraints

Anchor Constraints

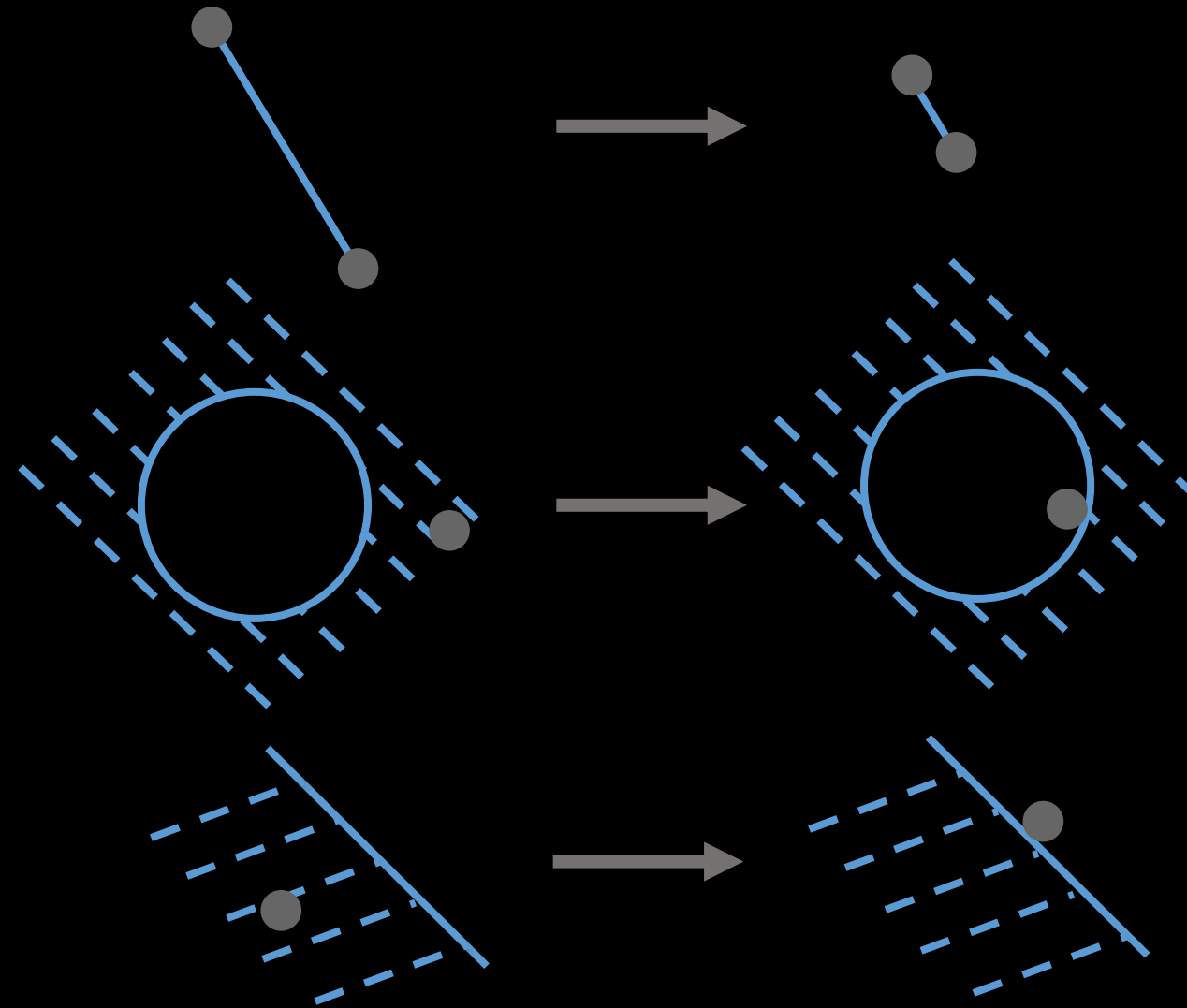


Simulating Cloth: How

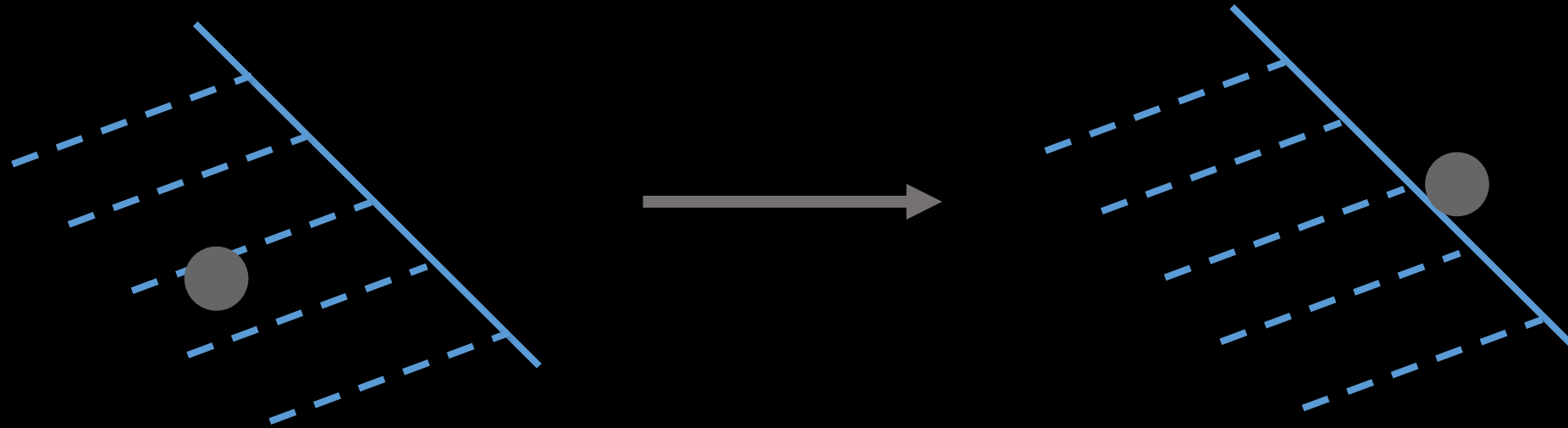
Length Constraints

Anchor Constraints

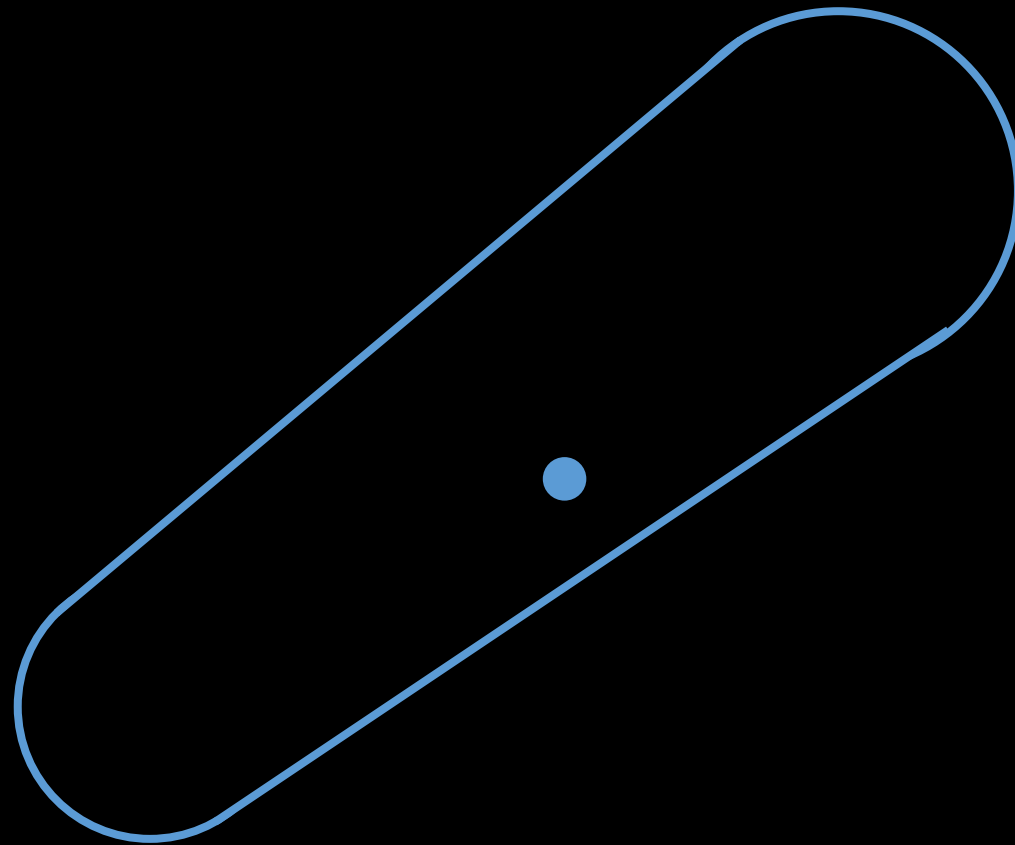
Contact Constraints



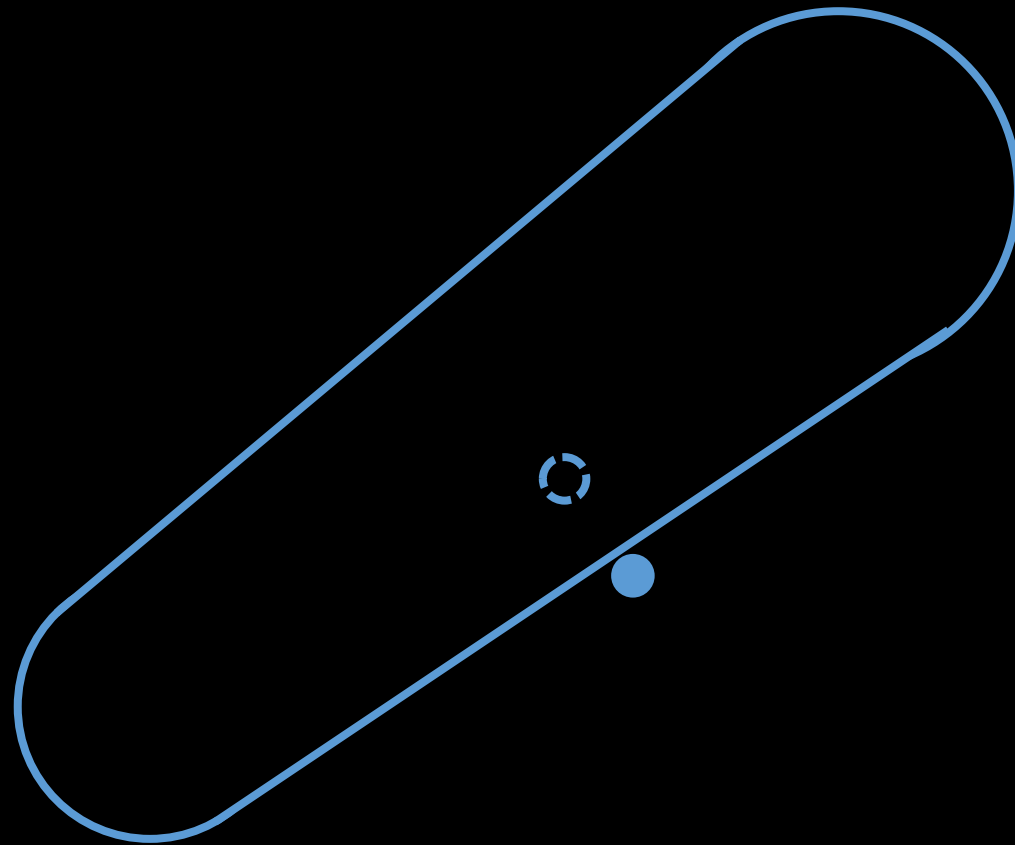
Collision



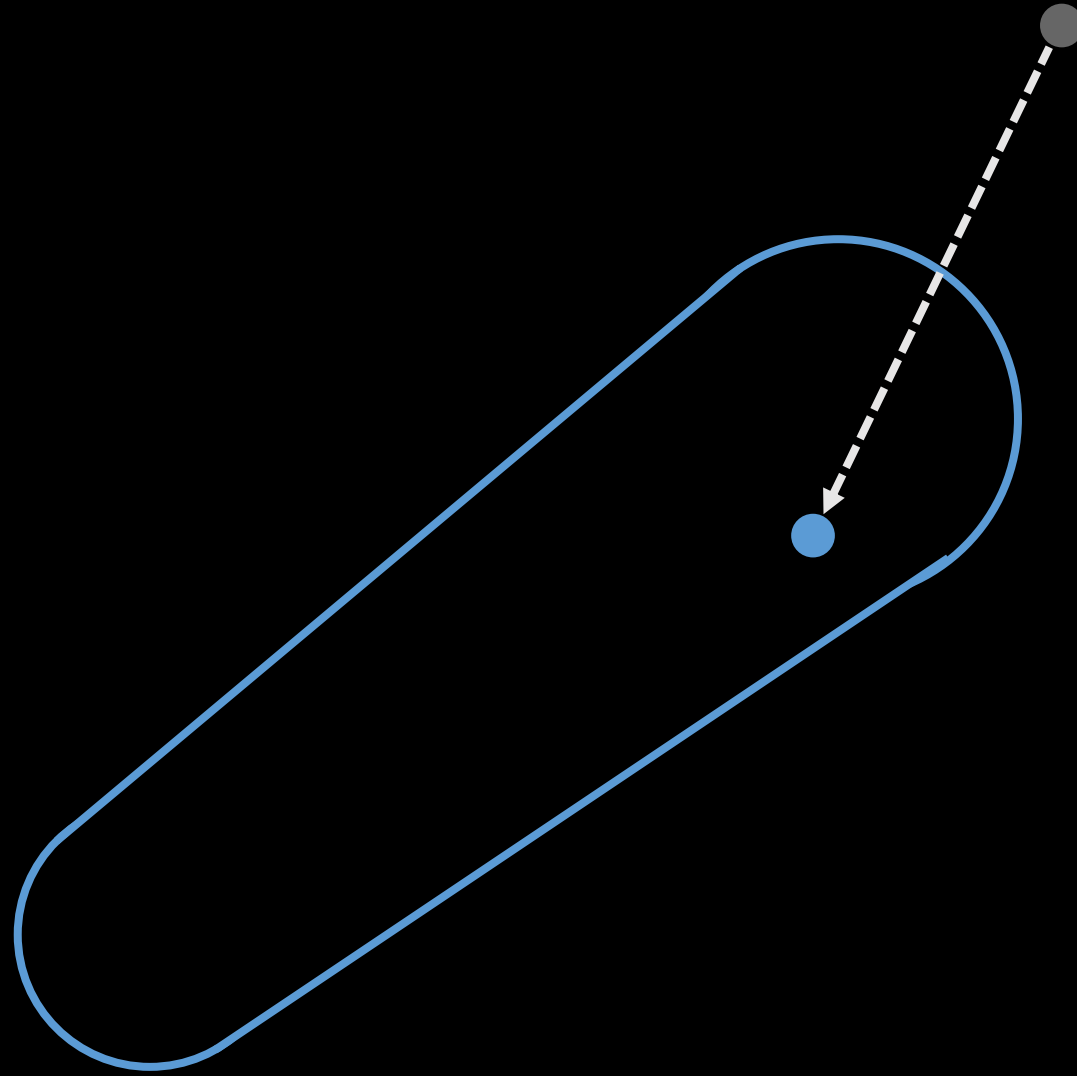
Discrete Collision



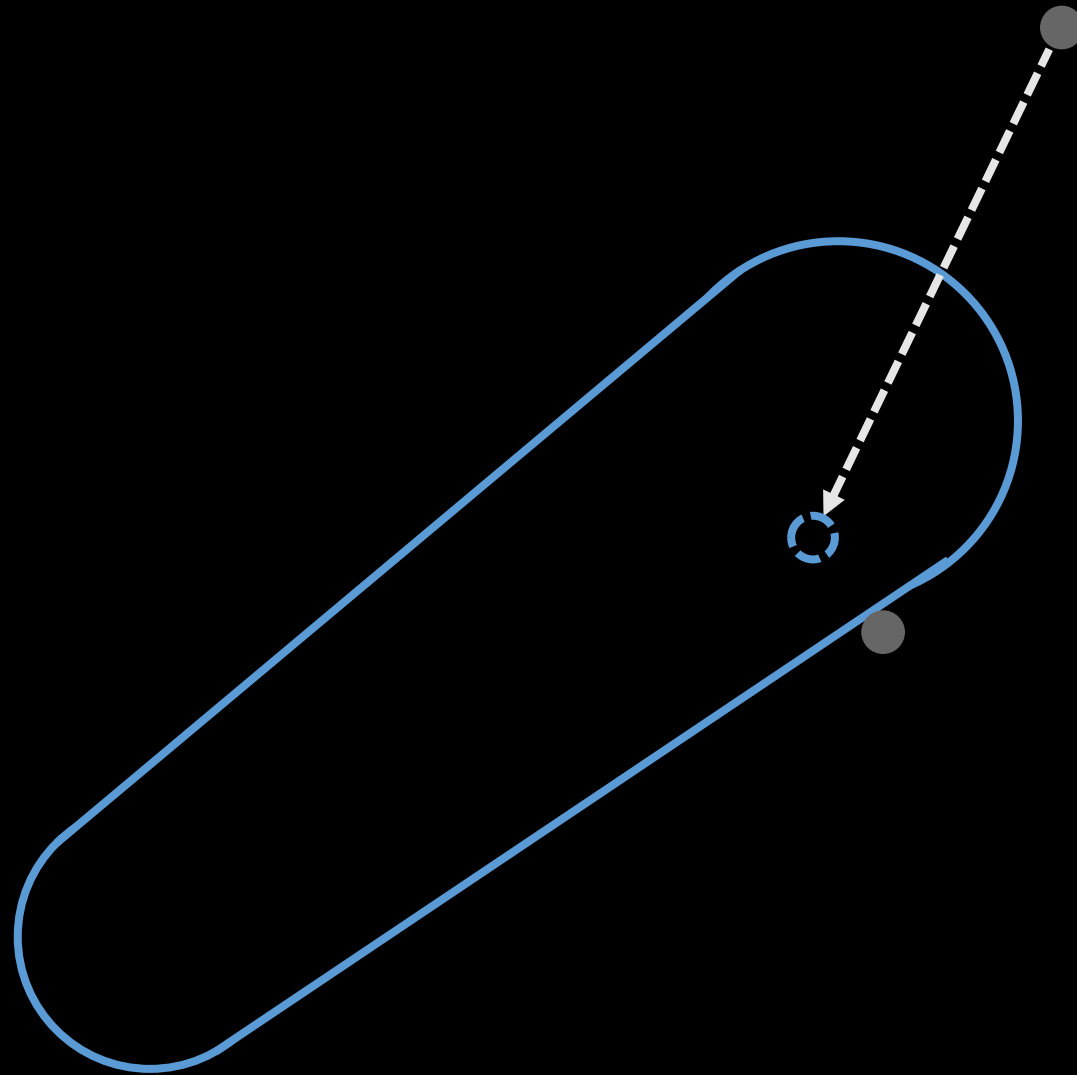
Discrete Collision



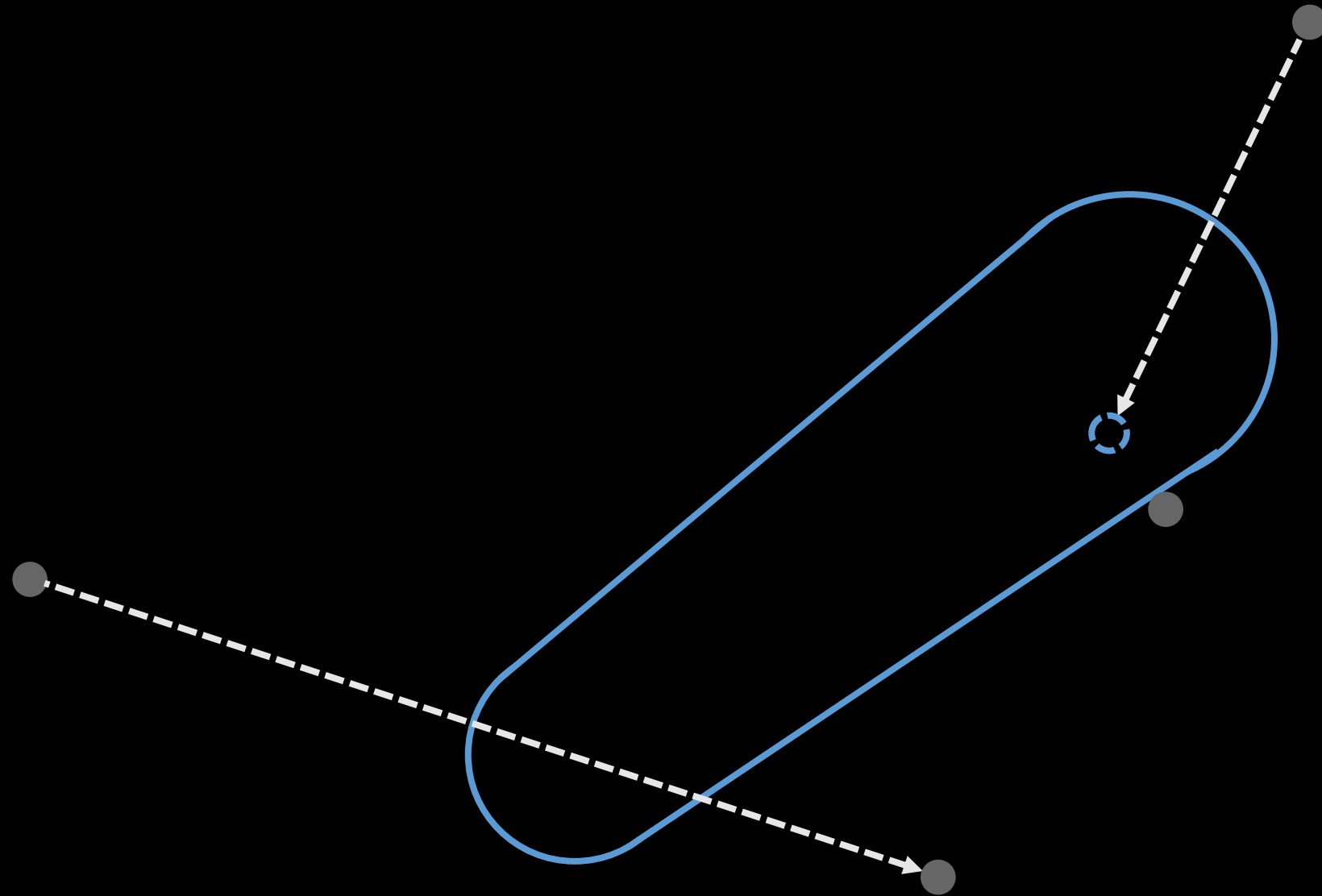
Discrete Collision



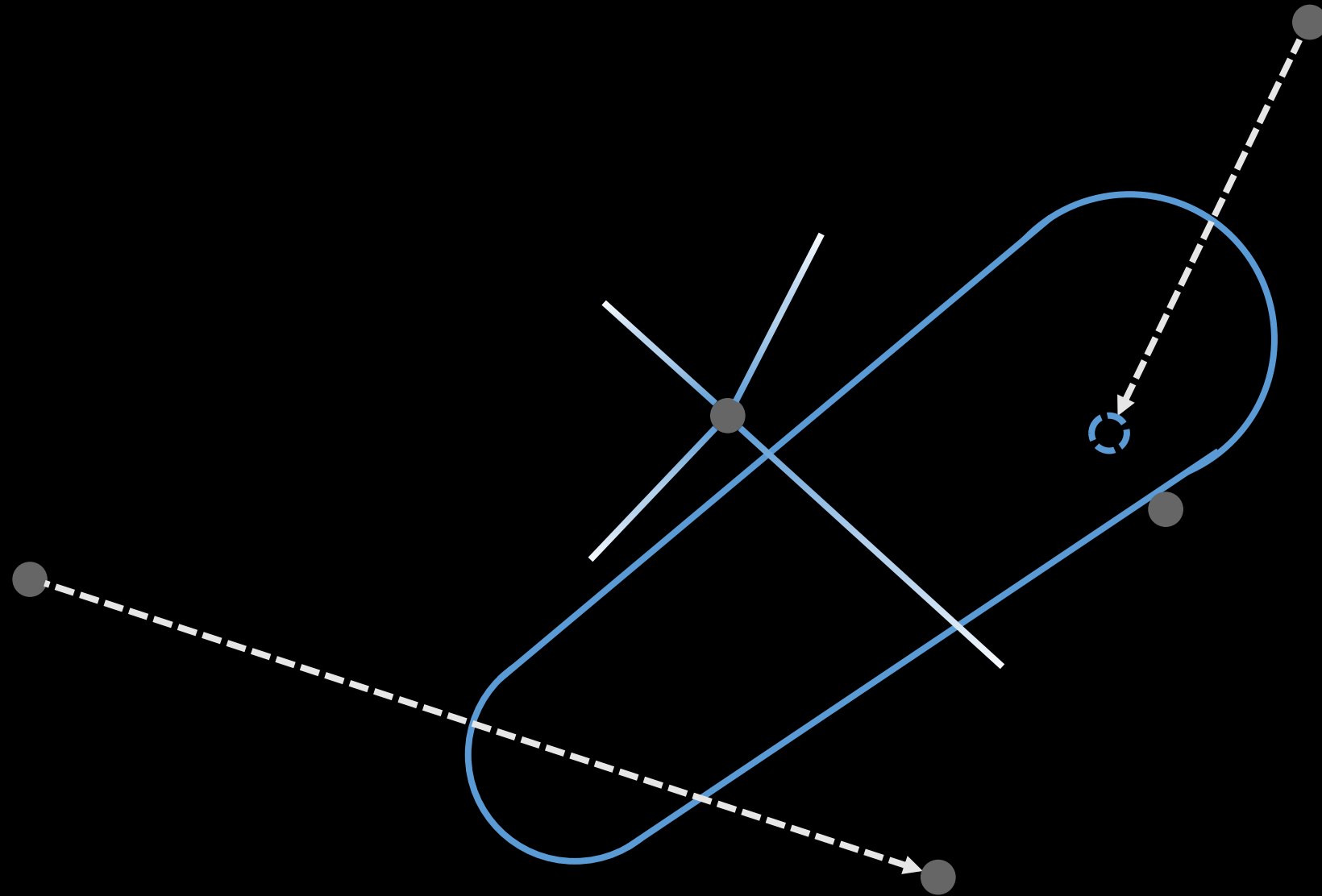
Discrete Collision



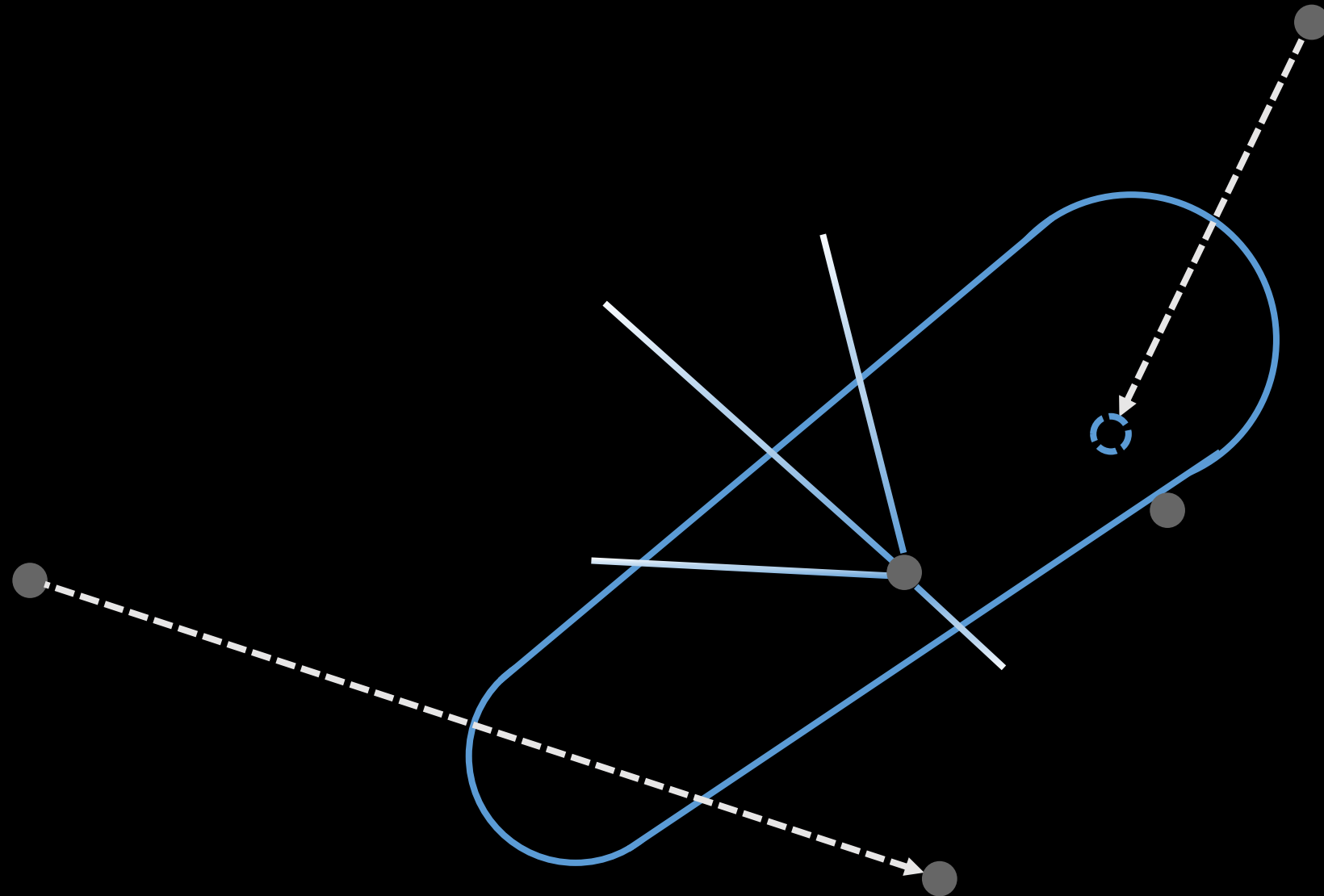
Discrete Collision



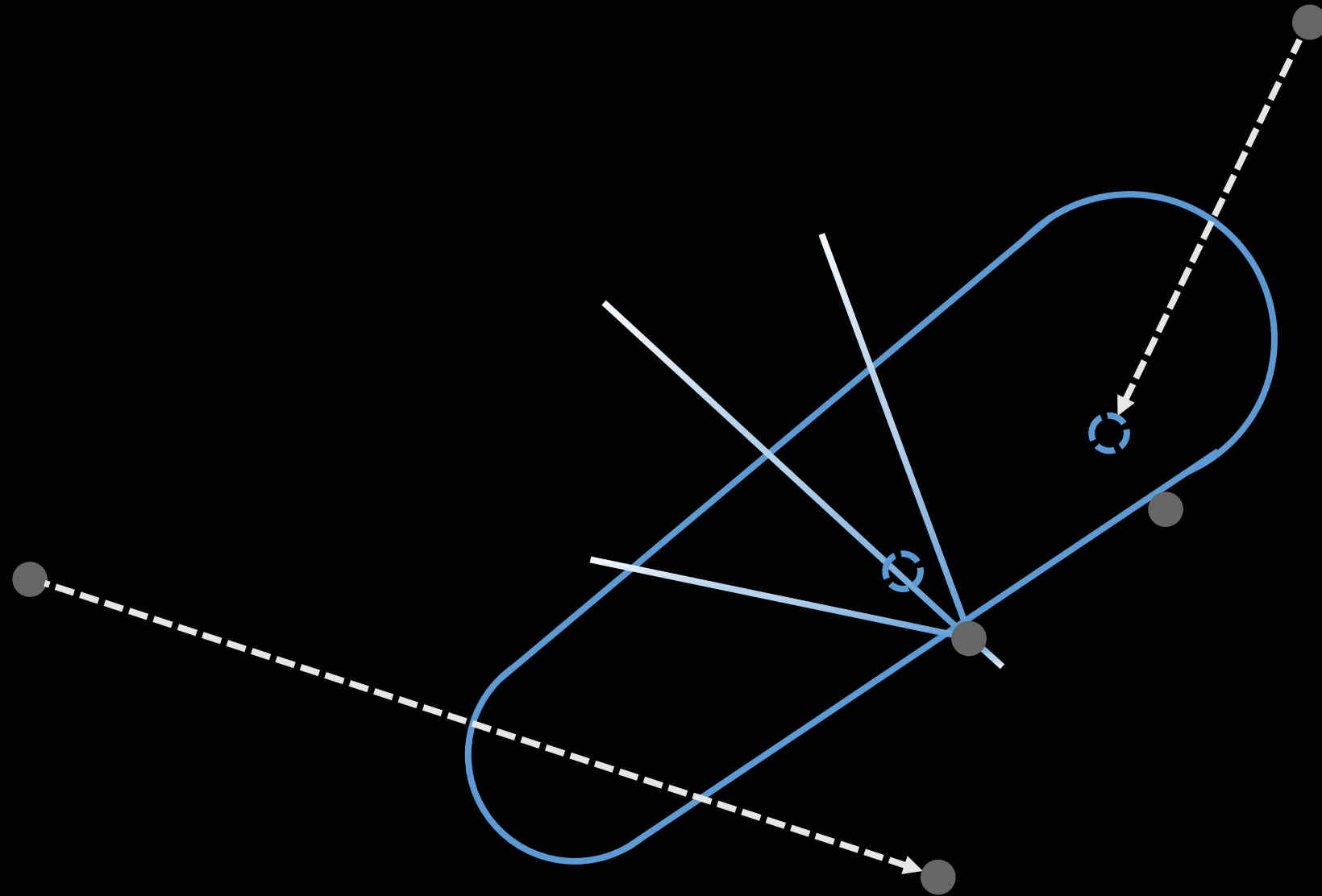
Discrete Collision



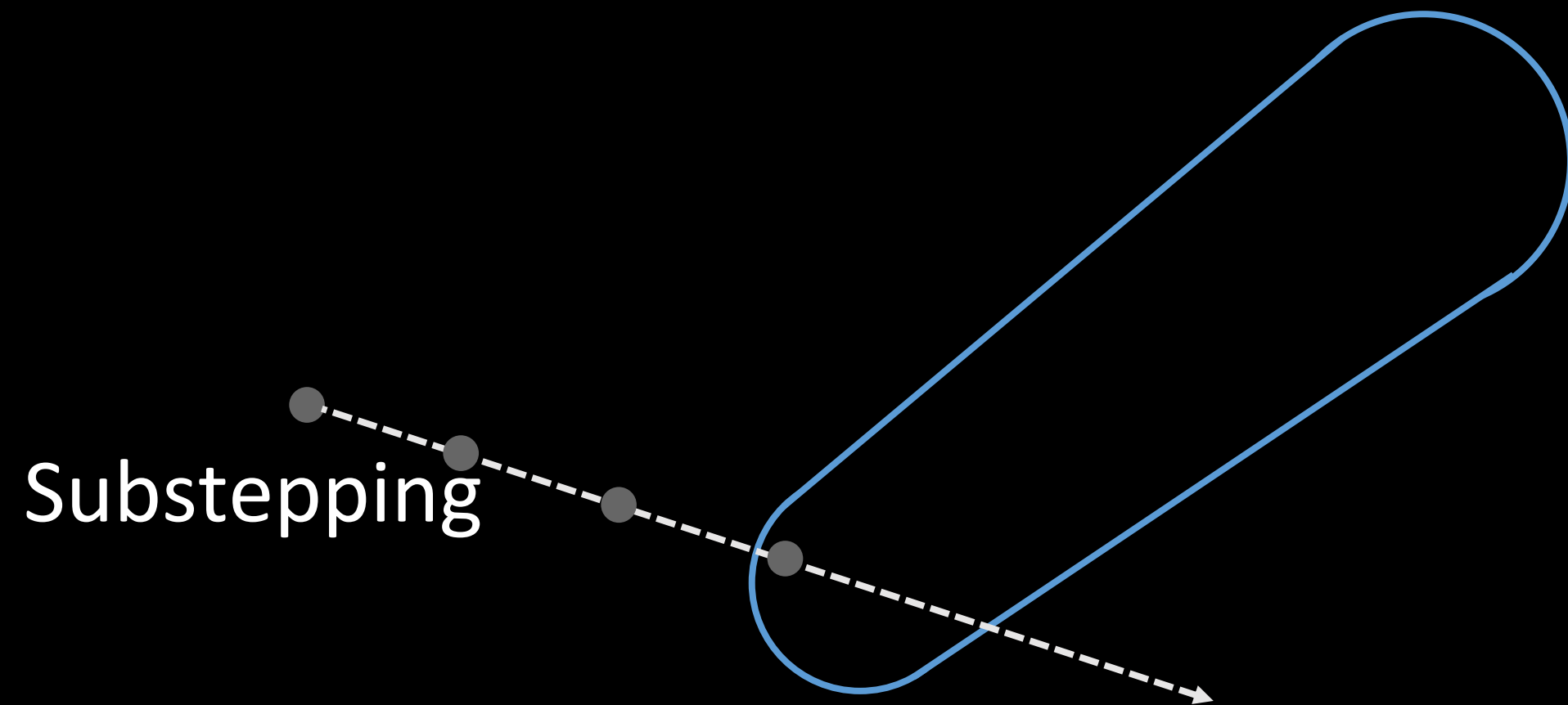
Discrete Collision



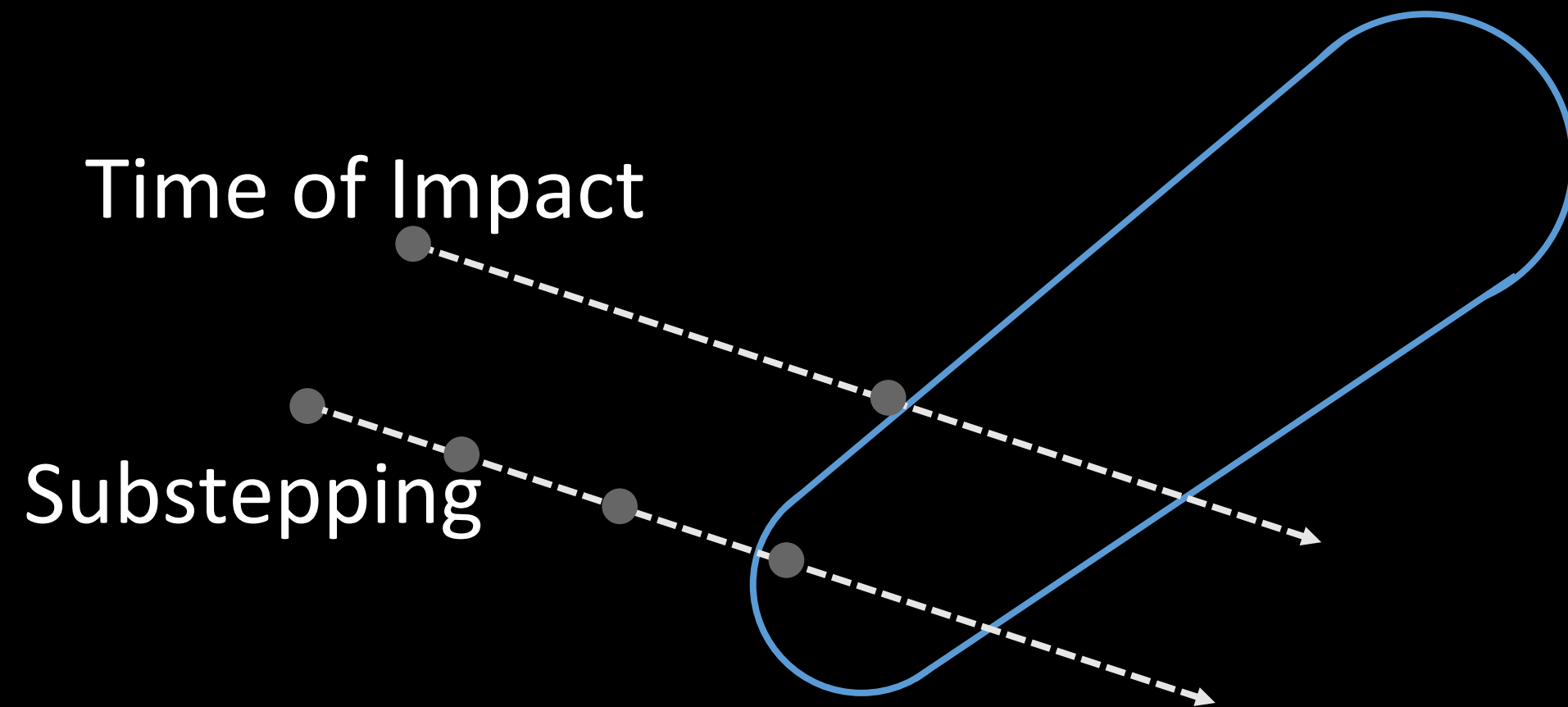
Discrete Collision



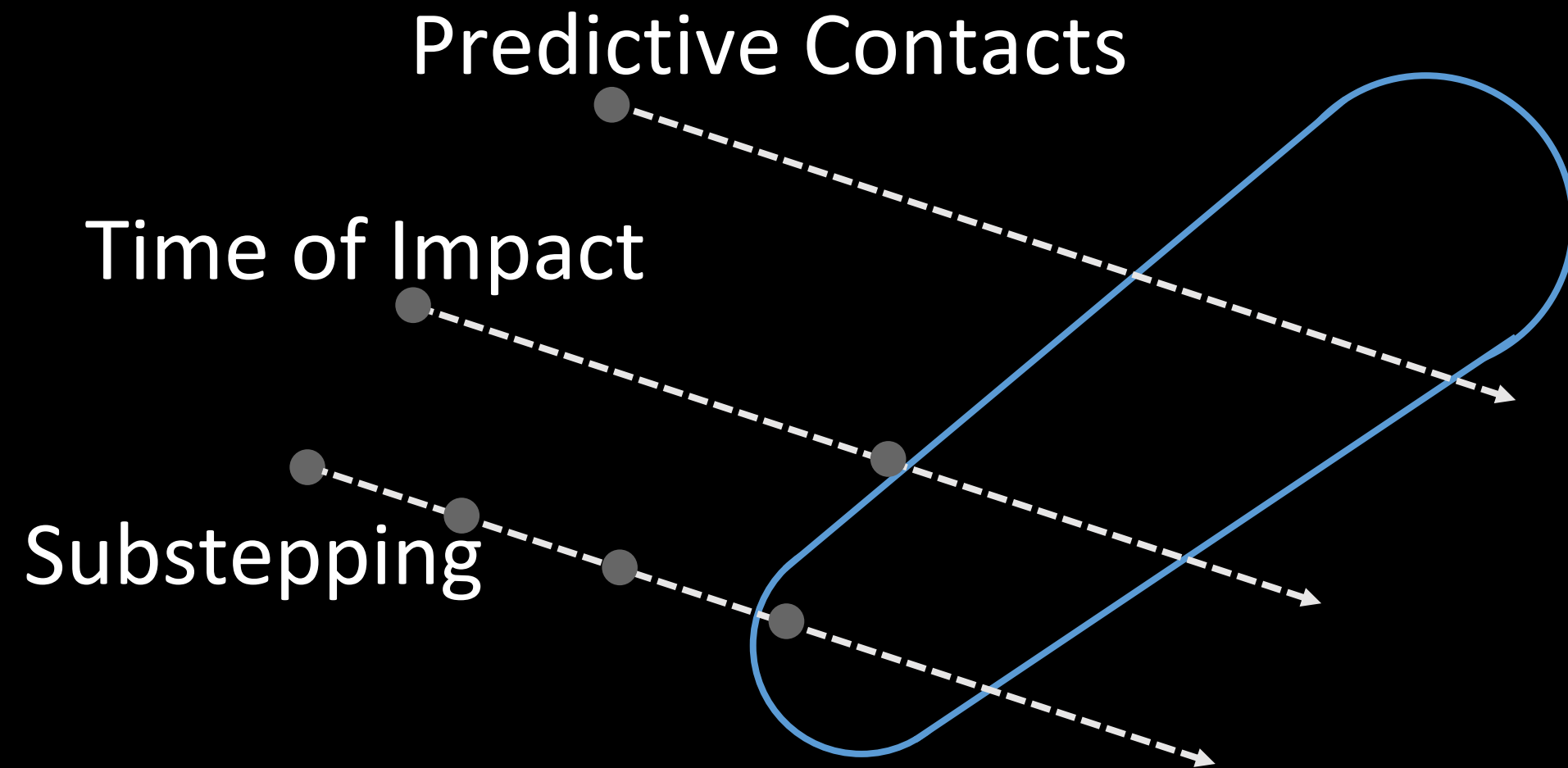
Continuous Collision



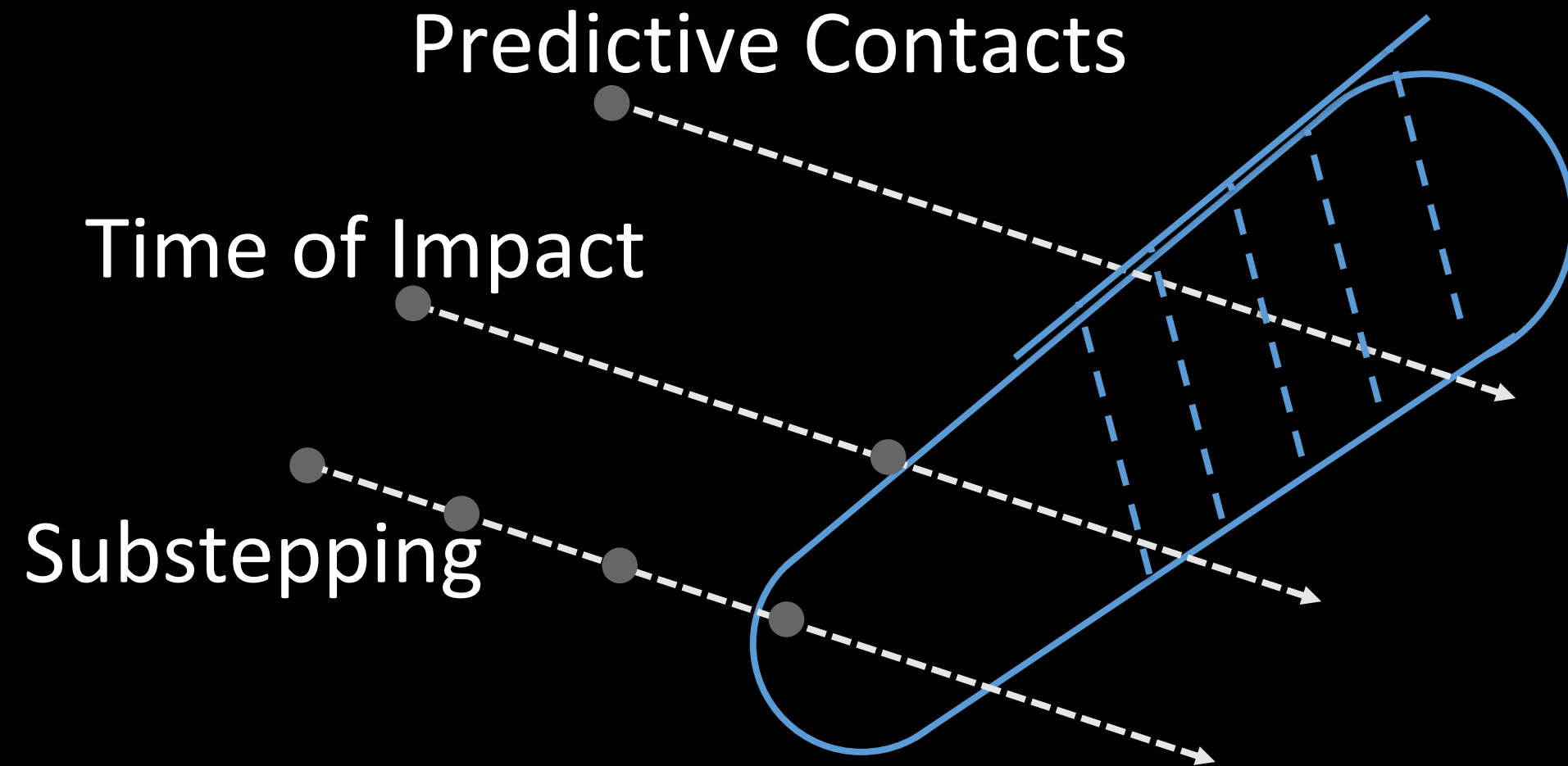
Continuous Collision



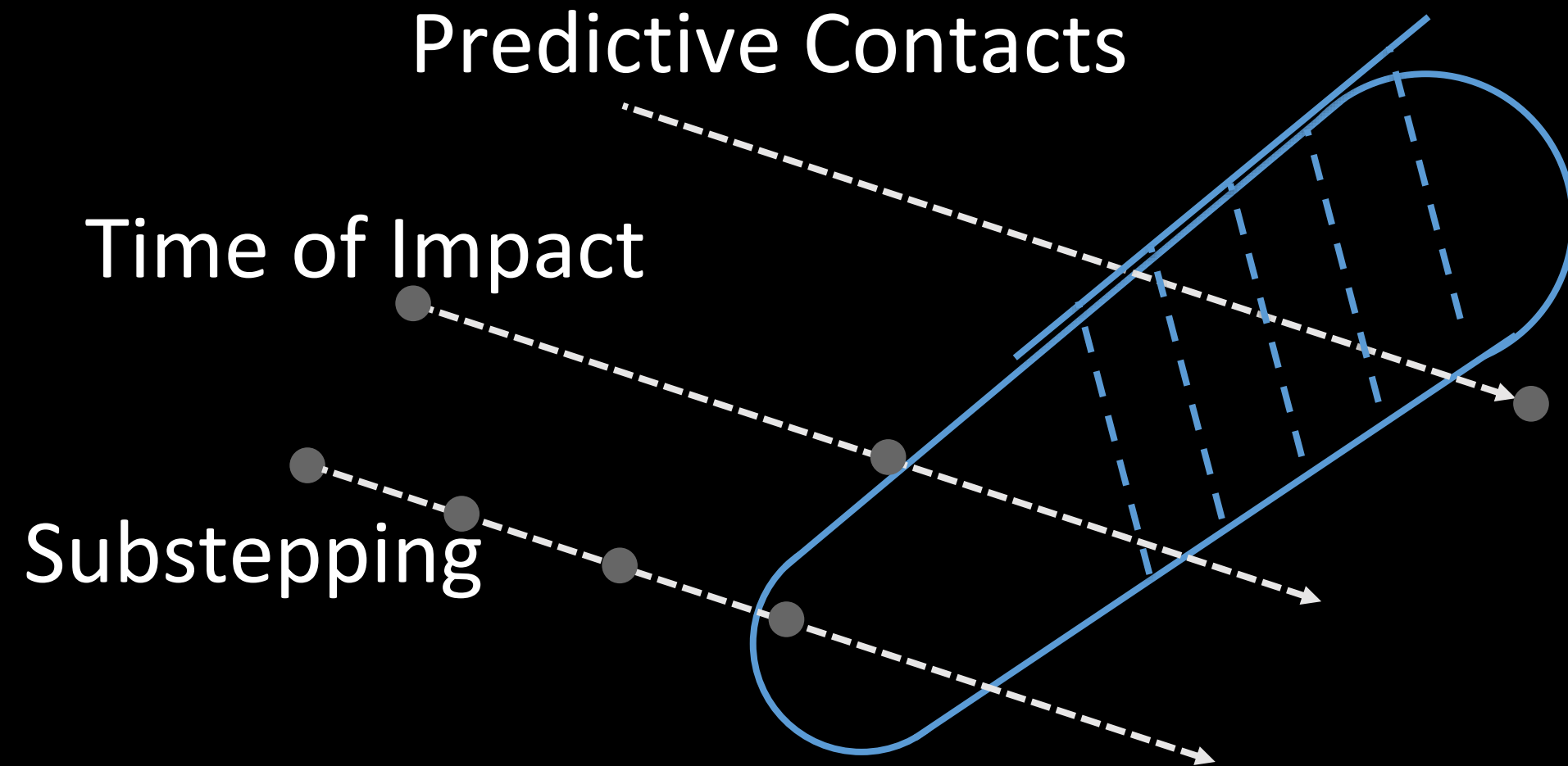
Continuous Collision



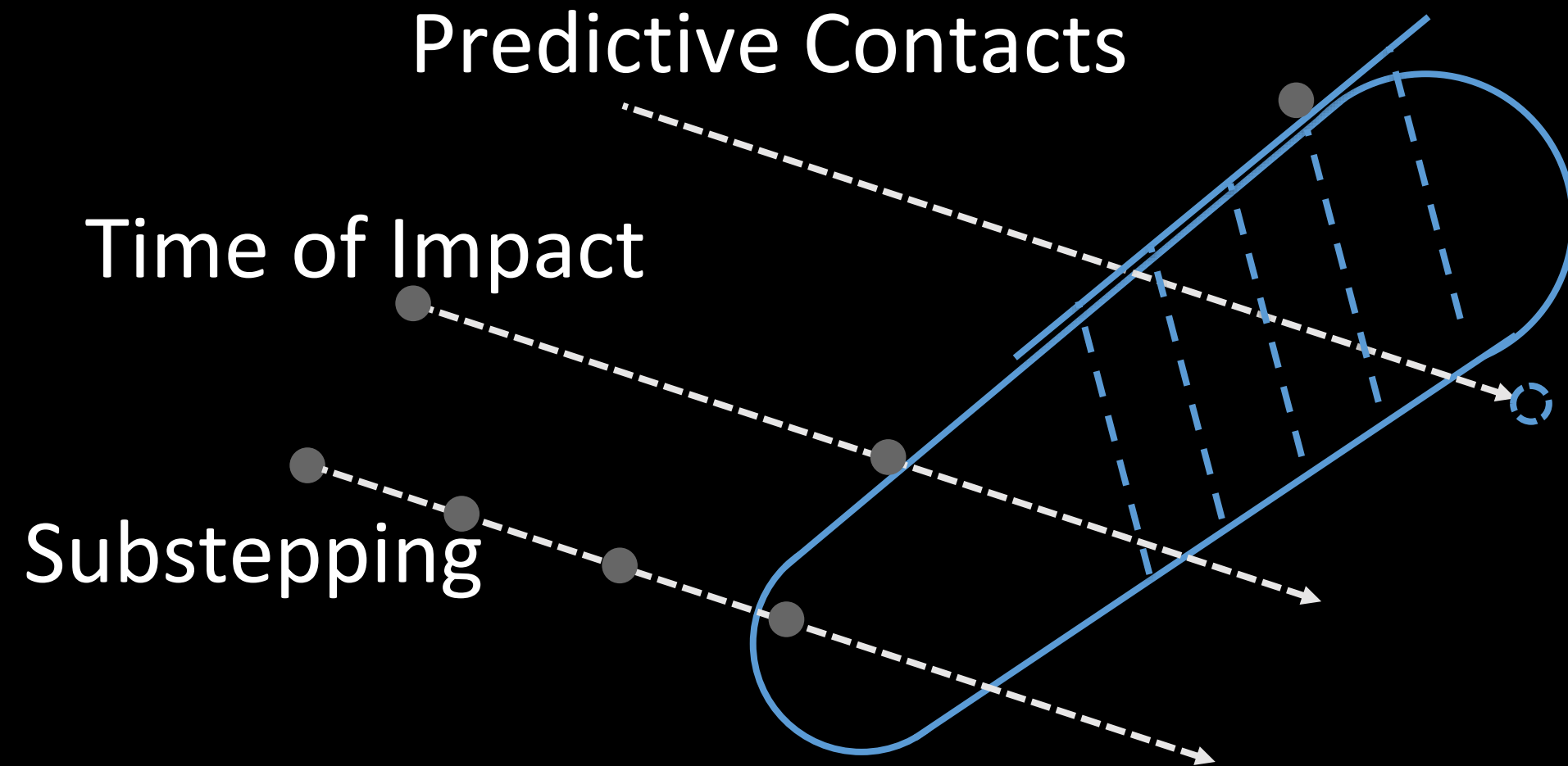
Continuous Collision



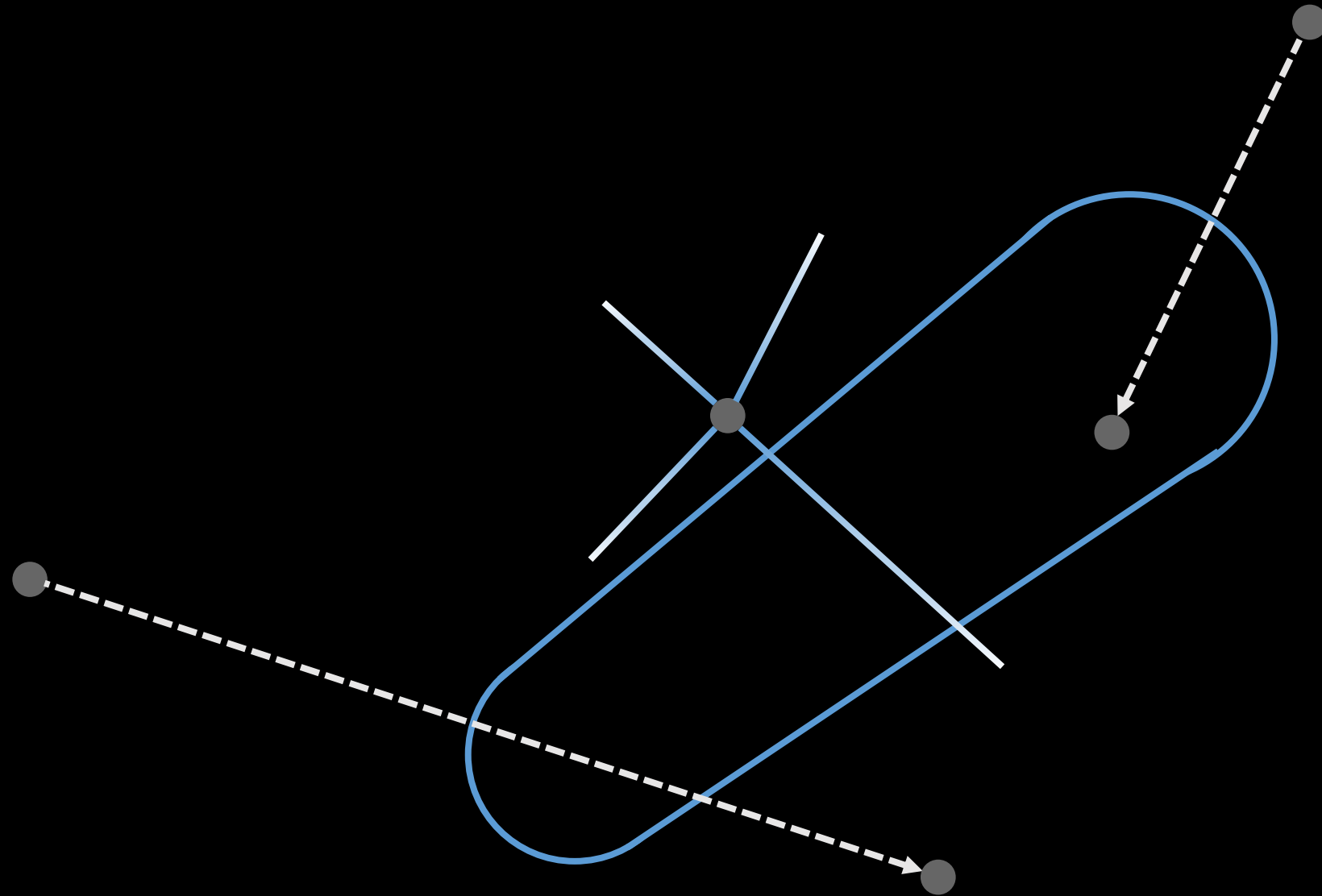
Continuous Collision



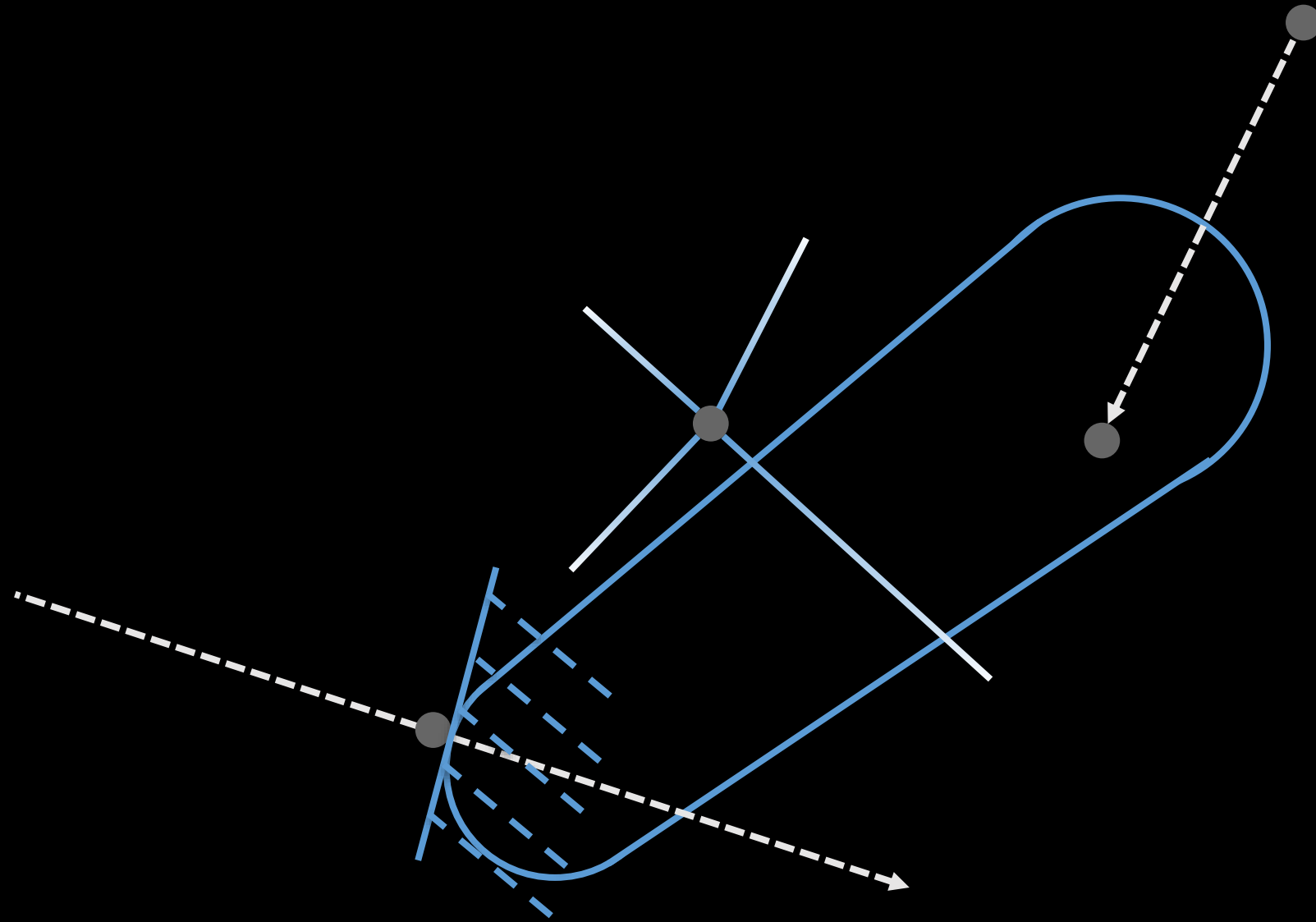
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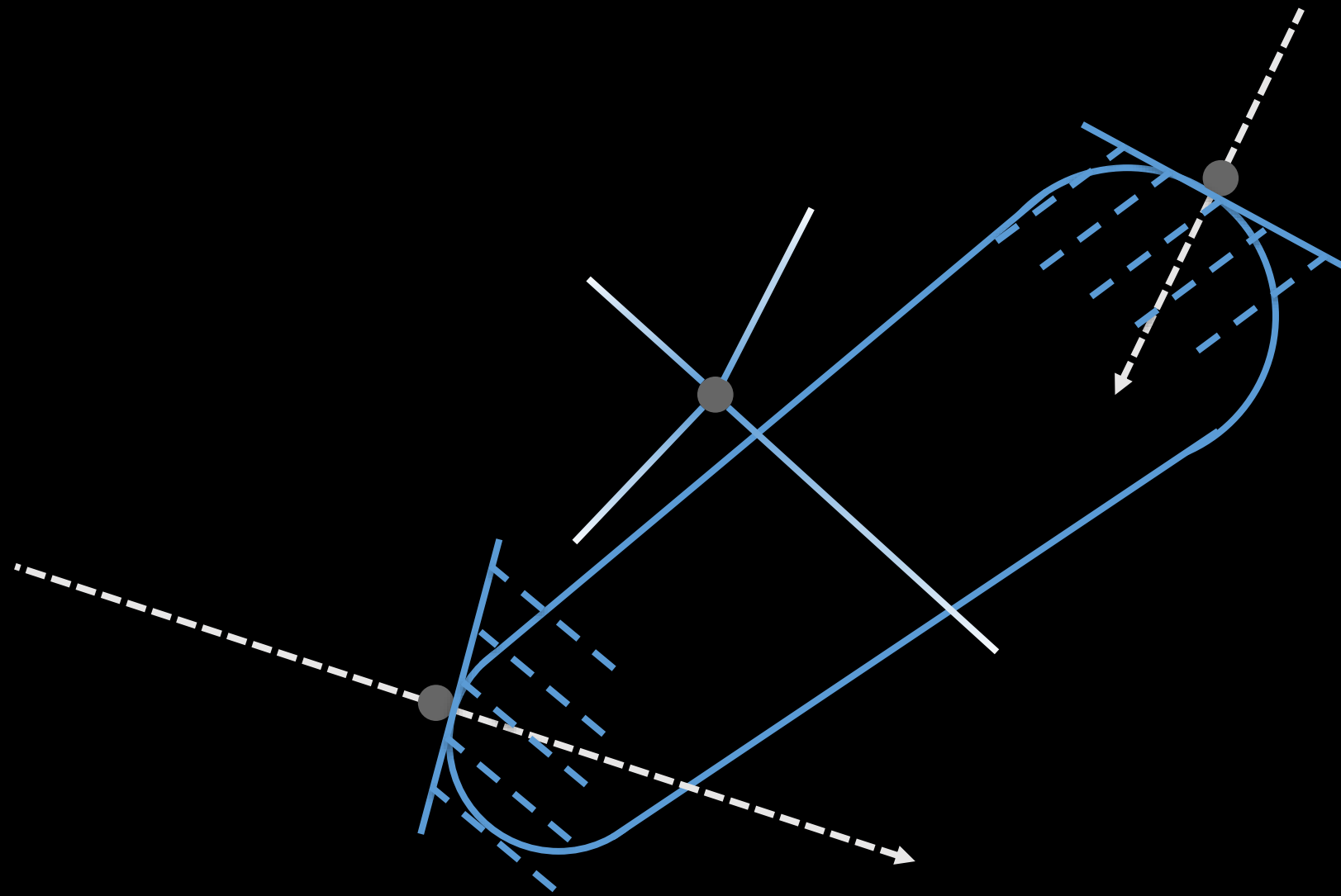
Continuous Collision



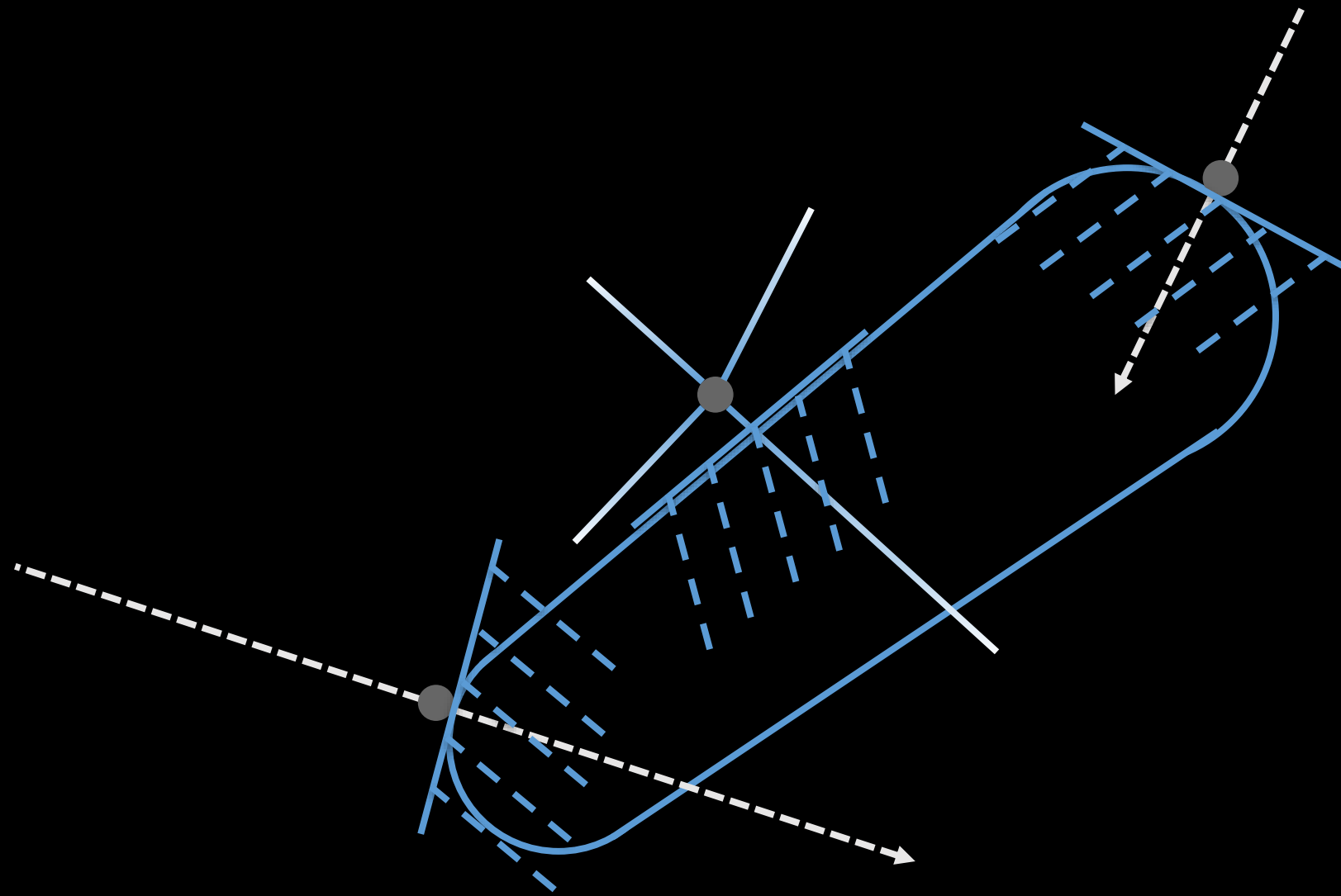
Continuous Collision



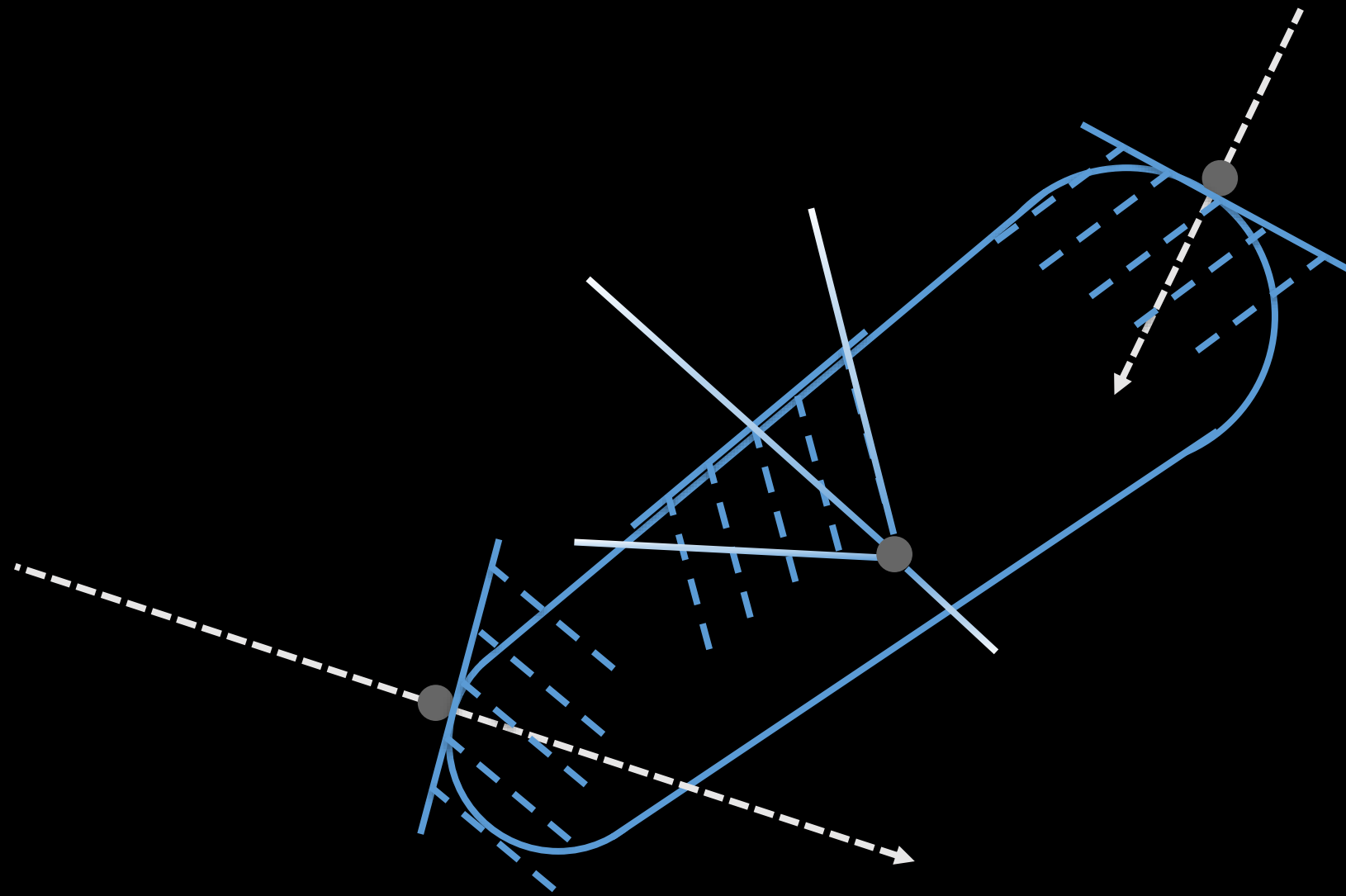
Continuous Collision



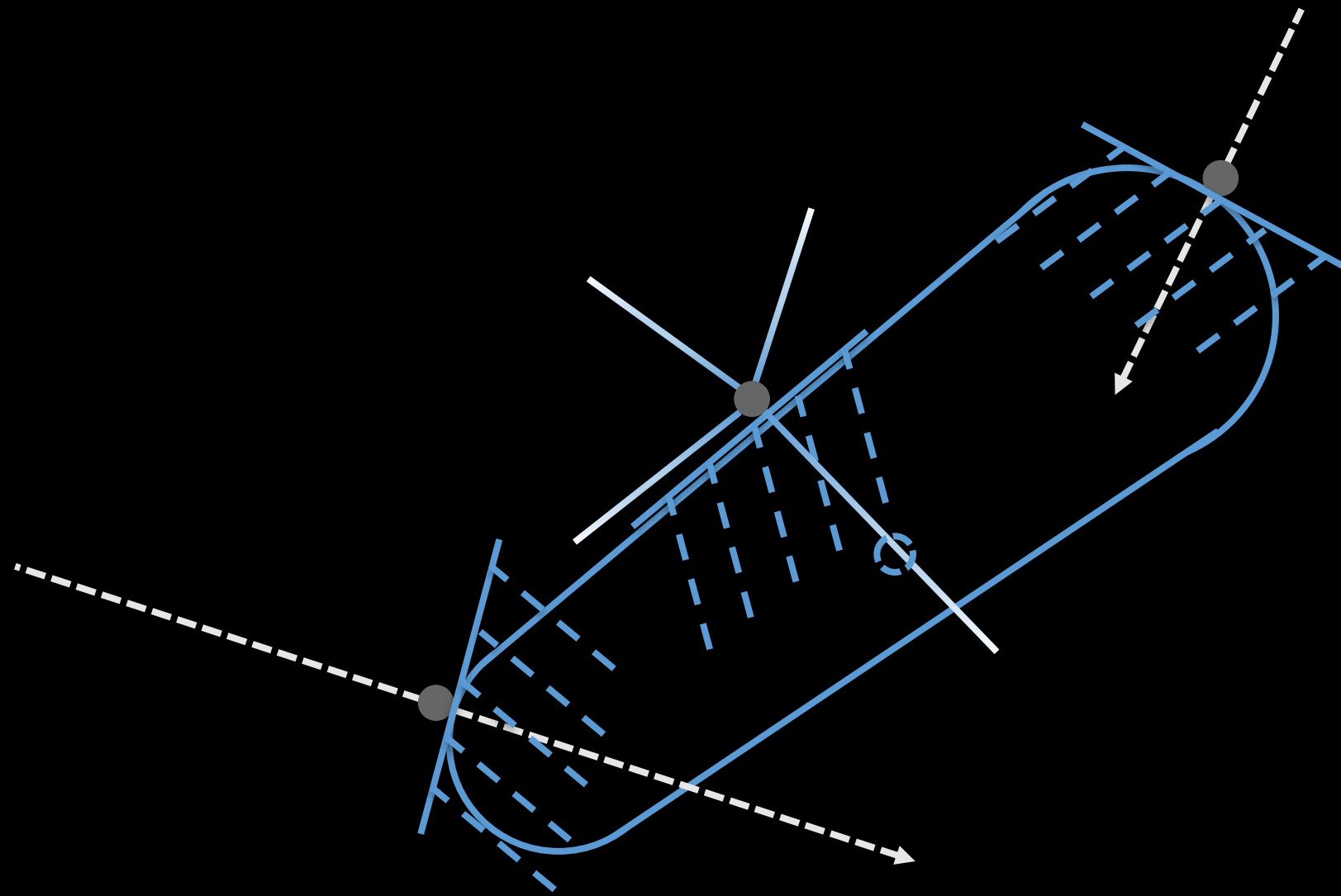
Continuous Collision



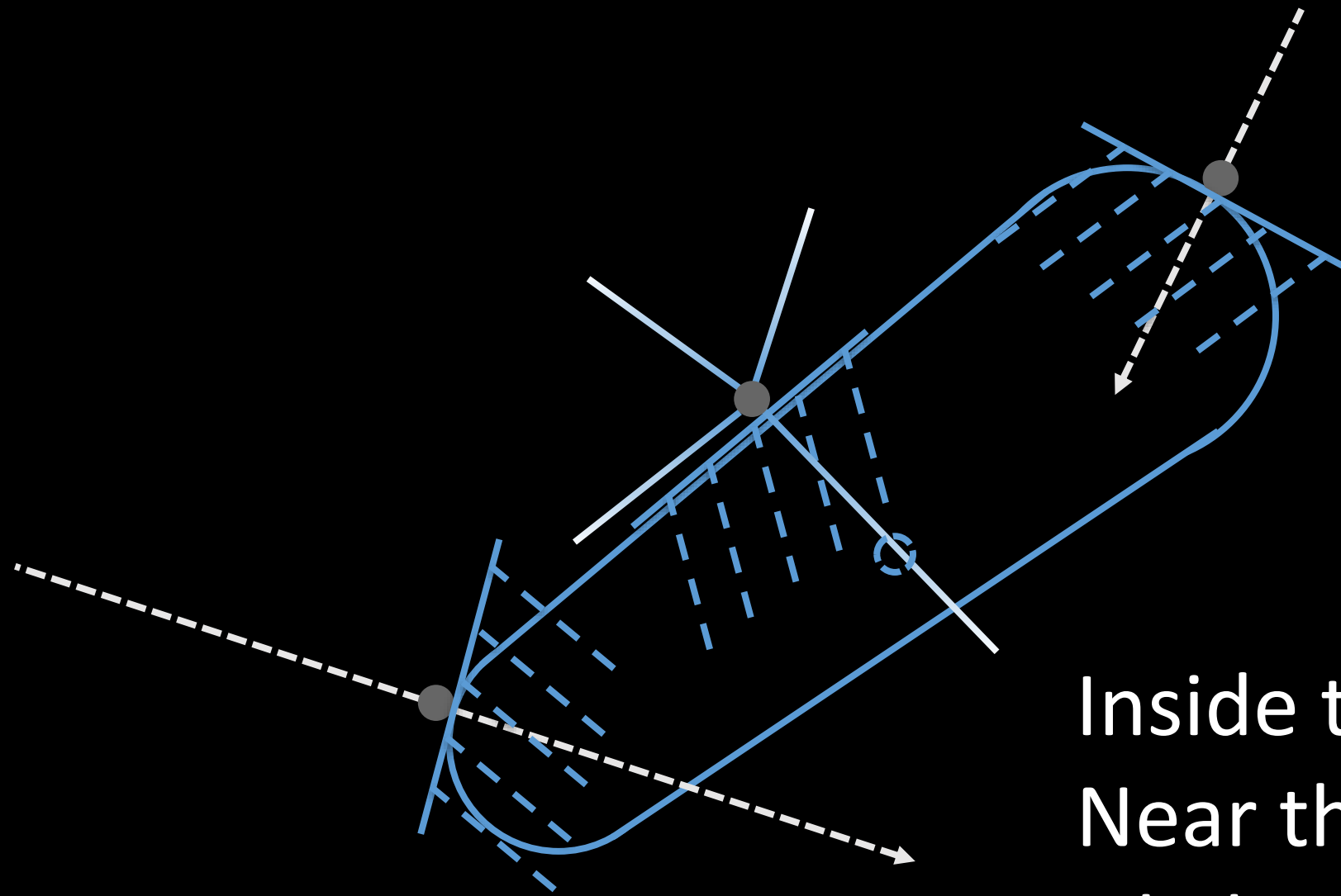
Continuous Collision



Continuous Collision



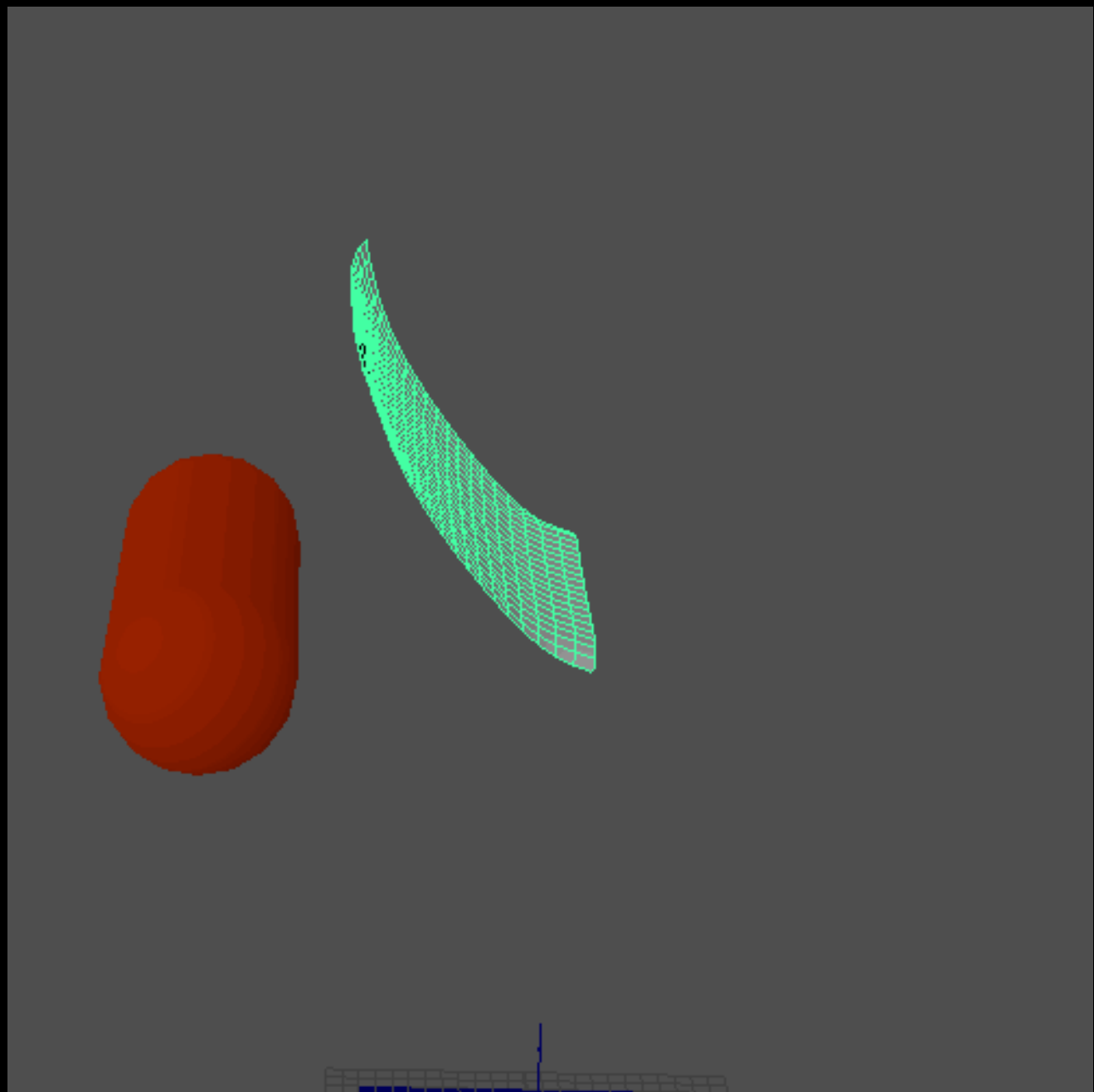
Continuous Collision



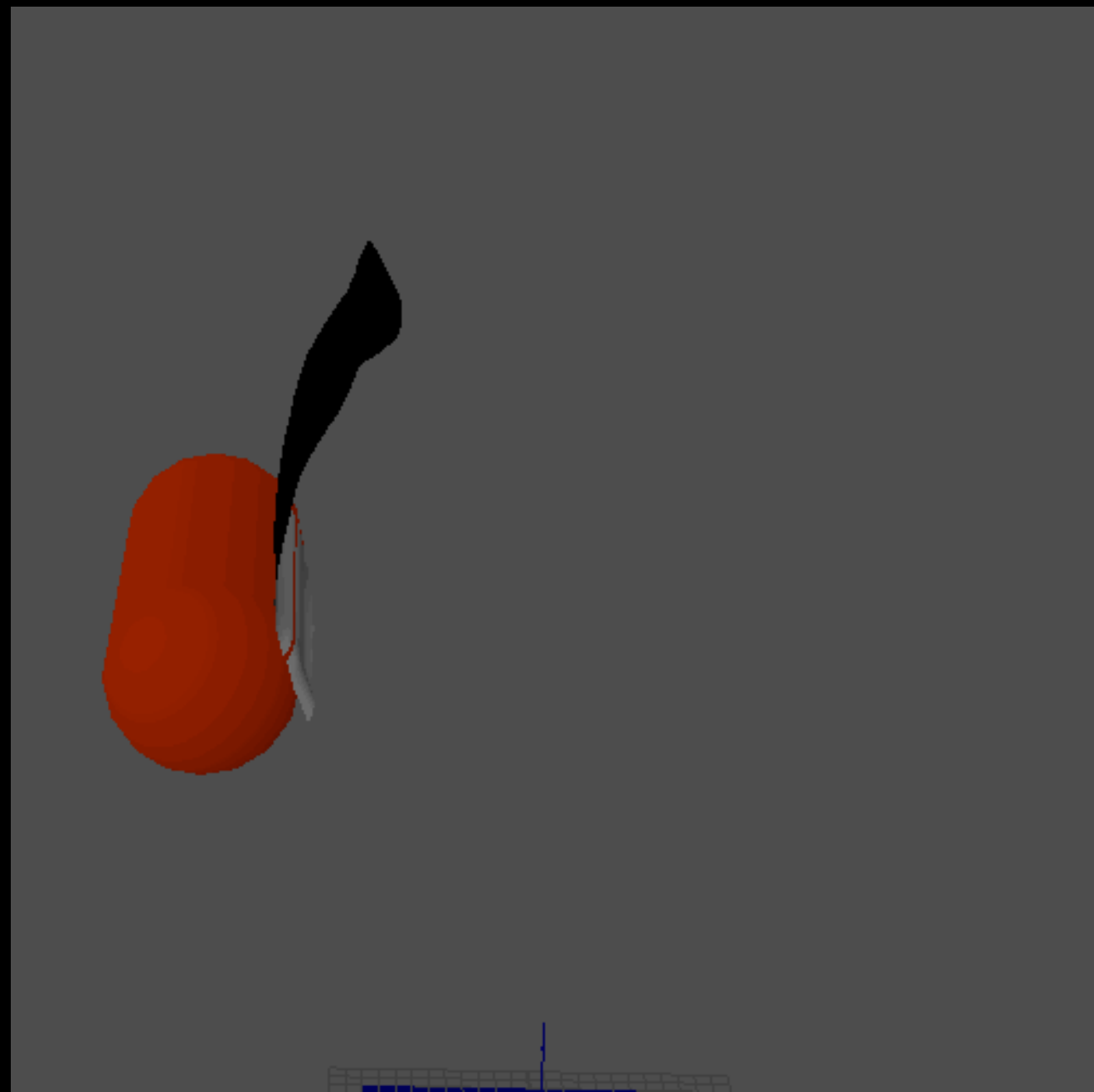
Inside the collider

Near the collider

Likely to be near the collider

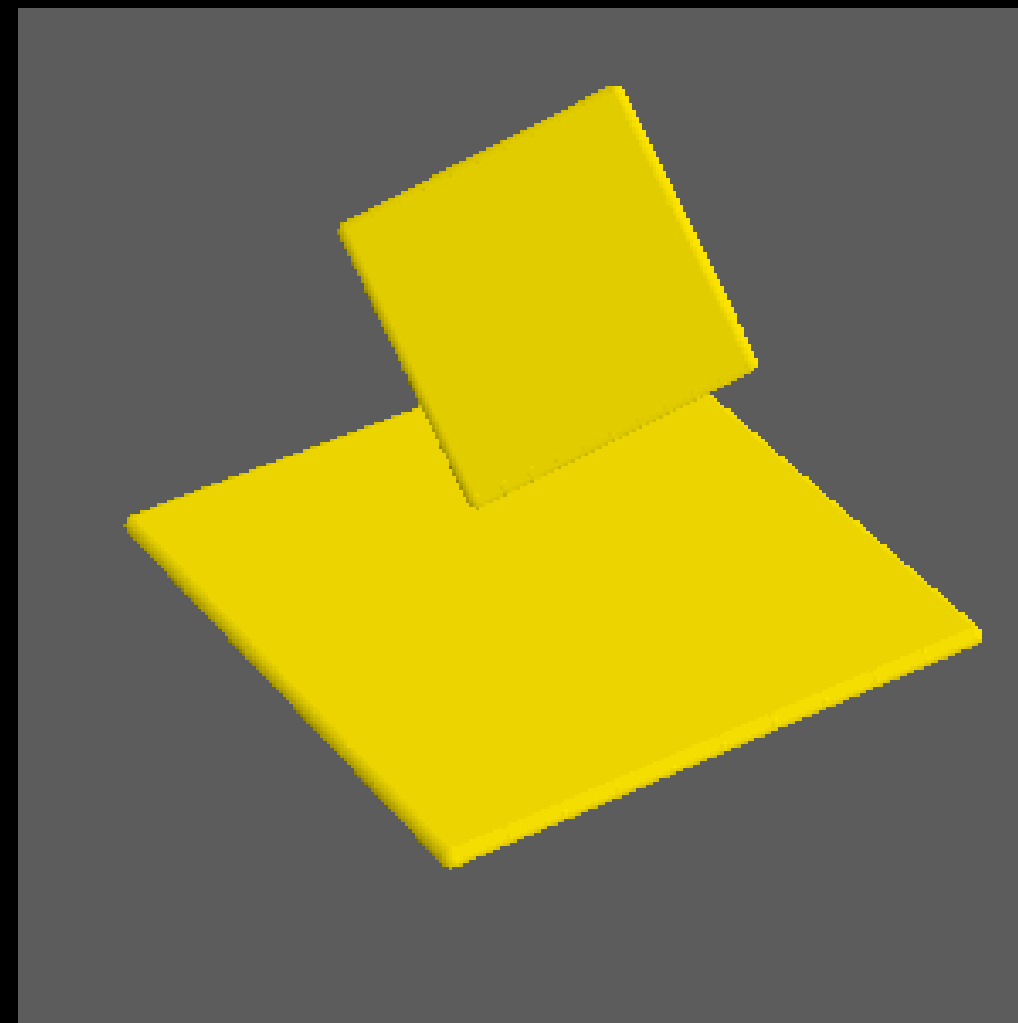
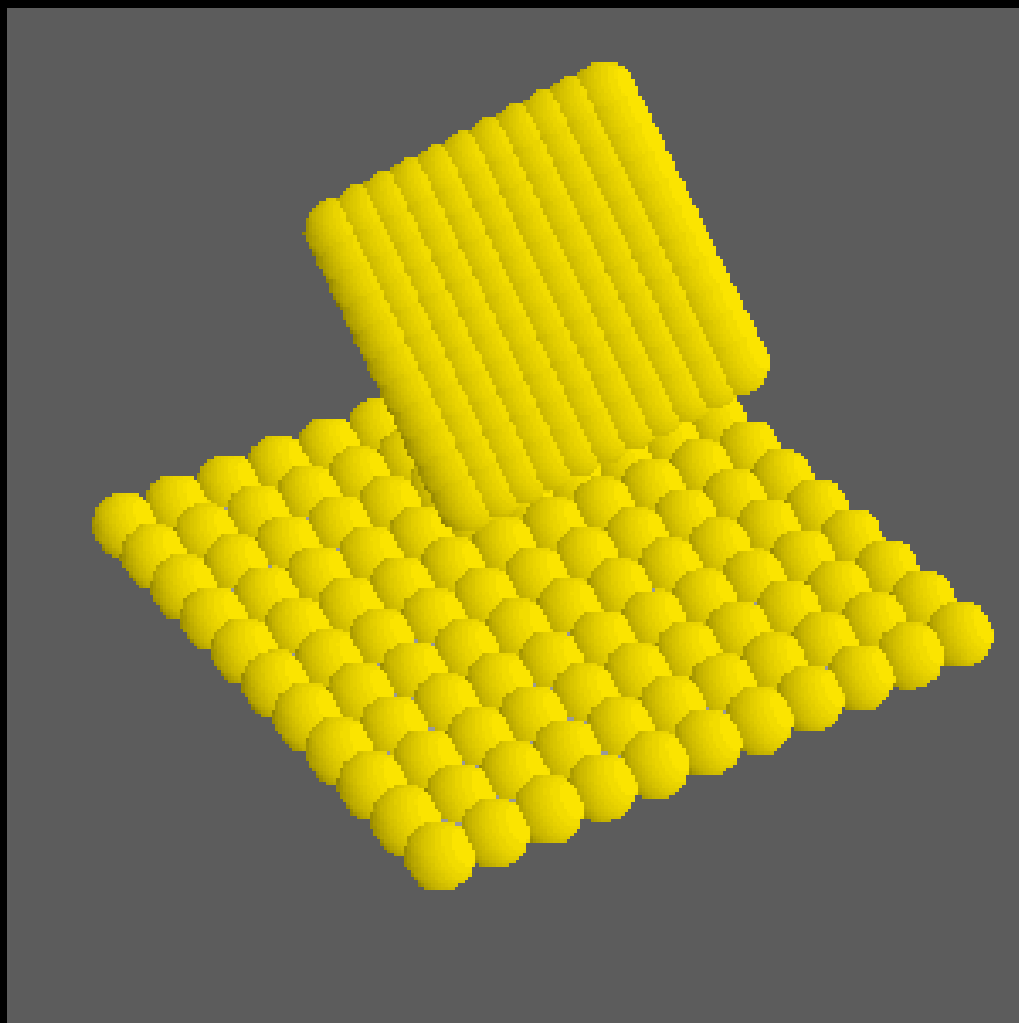


Discrete Collision

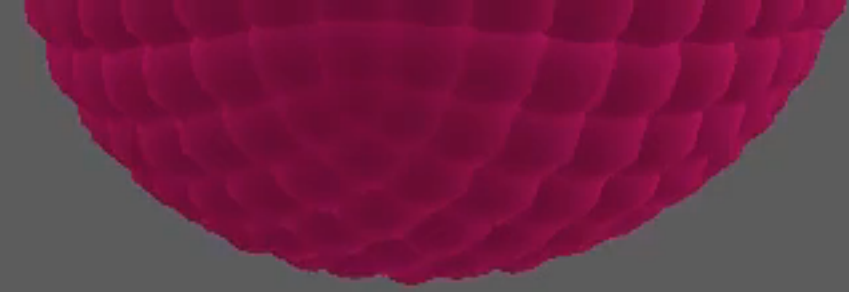


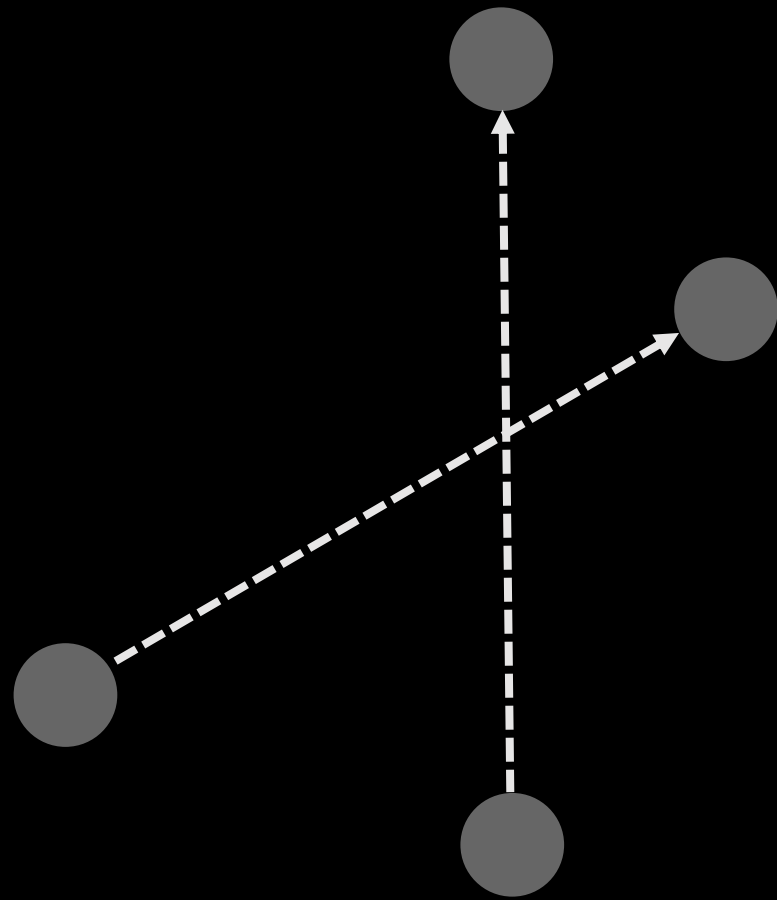
Predictive Contacts

Self Collision

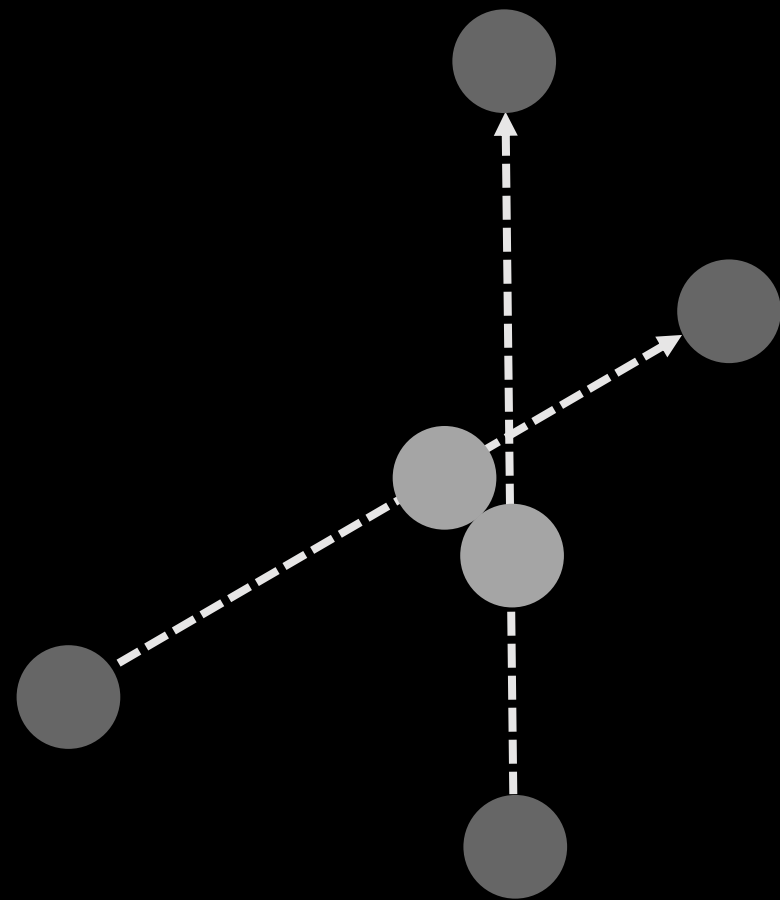


Point-Point Collision

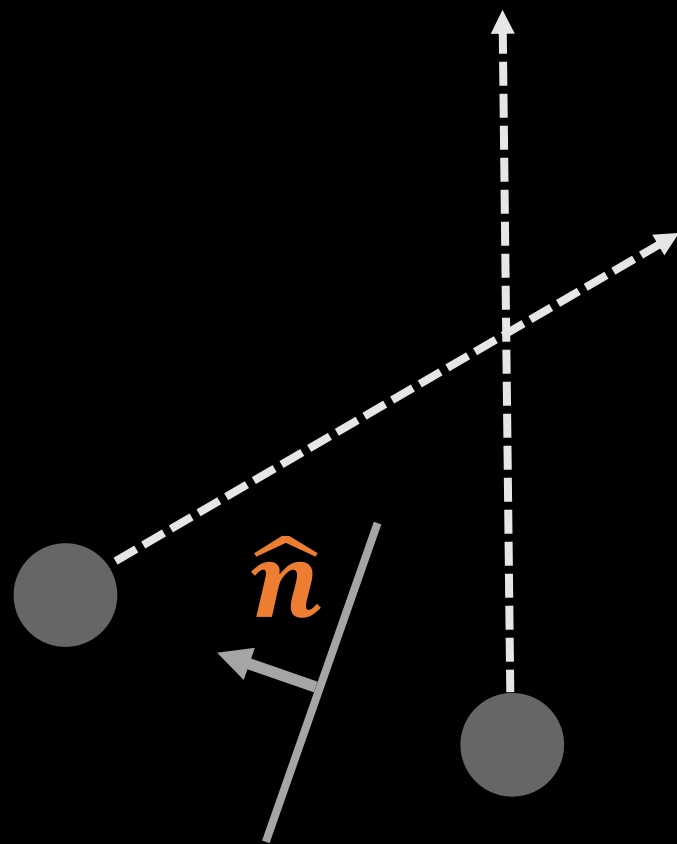




Contact Generation



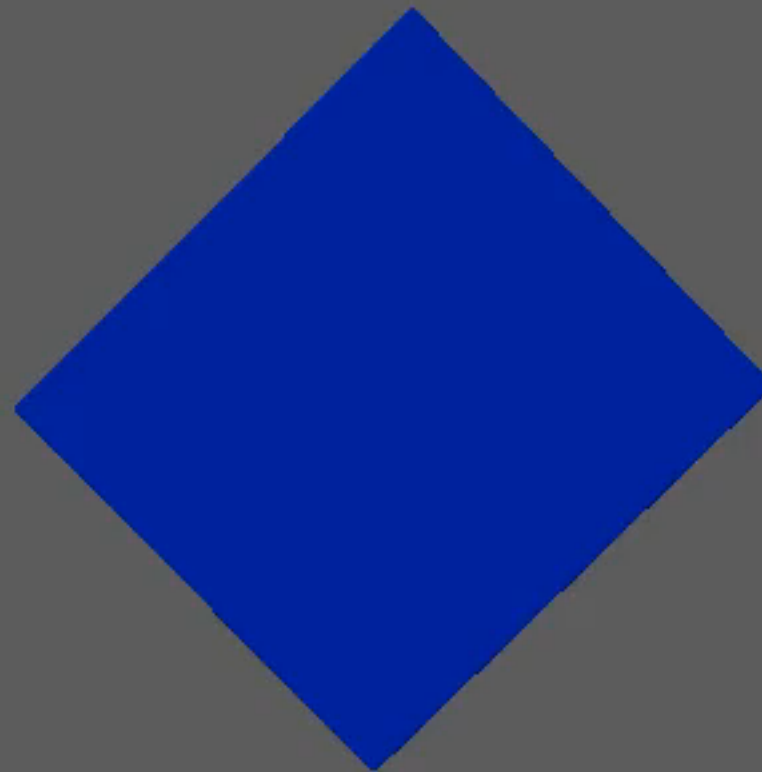
Contact Generation



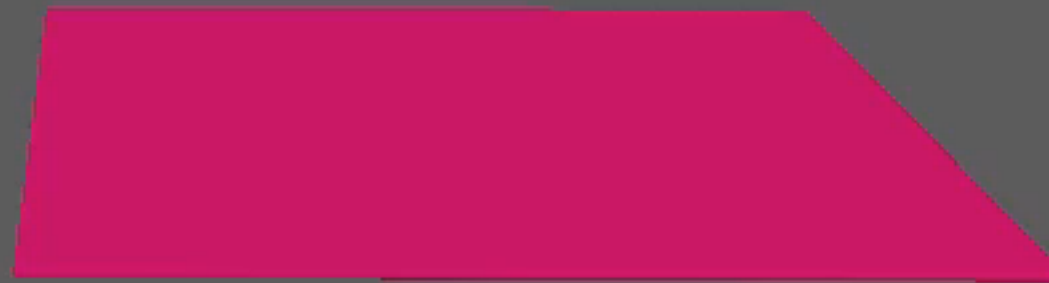
```
// Describes a contact between two points of the  
// cloth mesh, for self collision.  
struct PointPointContactDesc  
{  
    // Offset normal between the points at the  
    // beginning of the frame.  
    Vector3 normal;  
    // Index of the 0th point  
    uint16_t p0;  
    // Index of the 1st point  
    uint16_t p1;  
};
```

Contact Generation

Full Mesh Collision

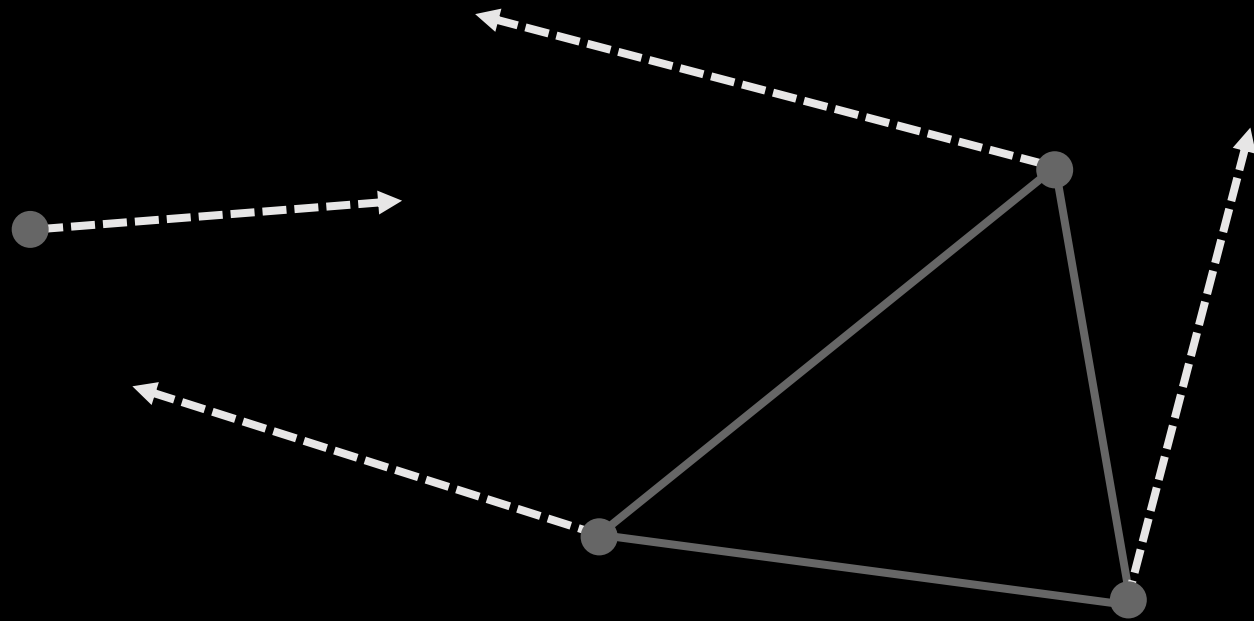


Edge-Edge

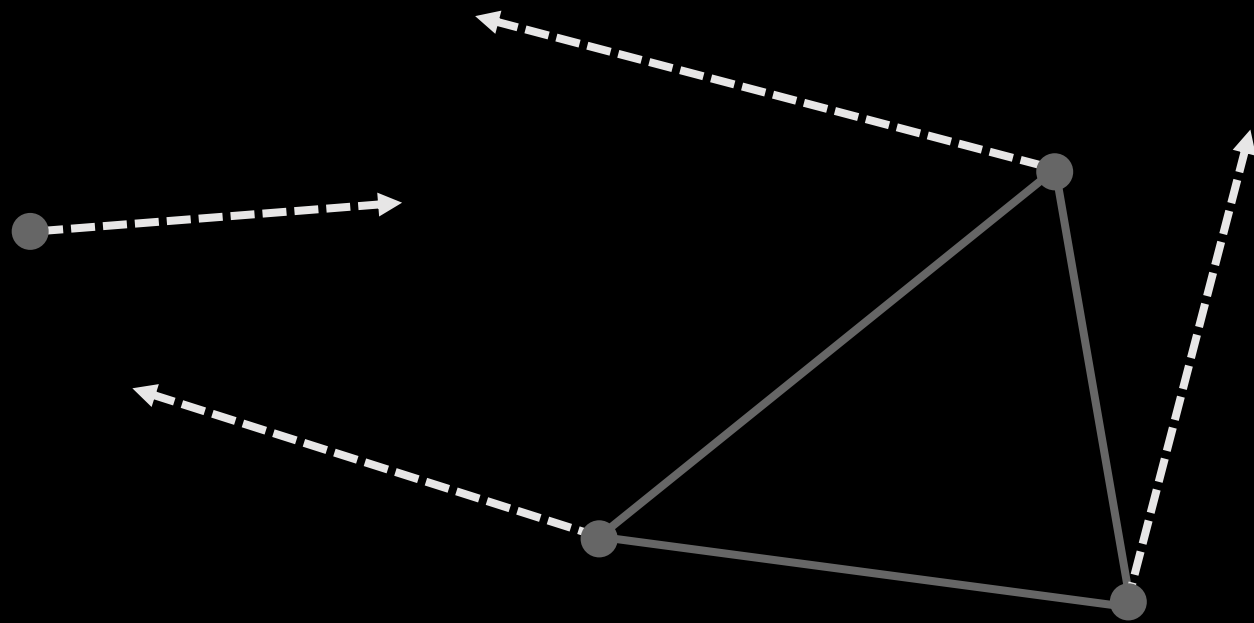


Point-Triangle

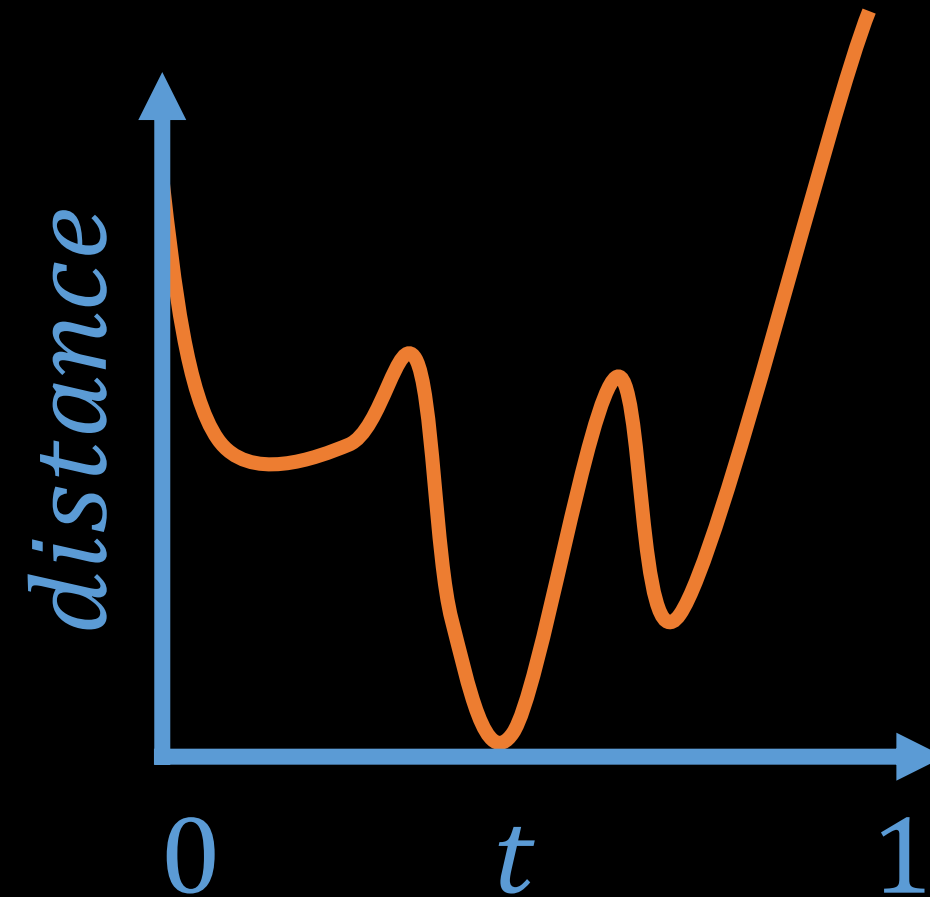
Point-Triangle



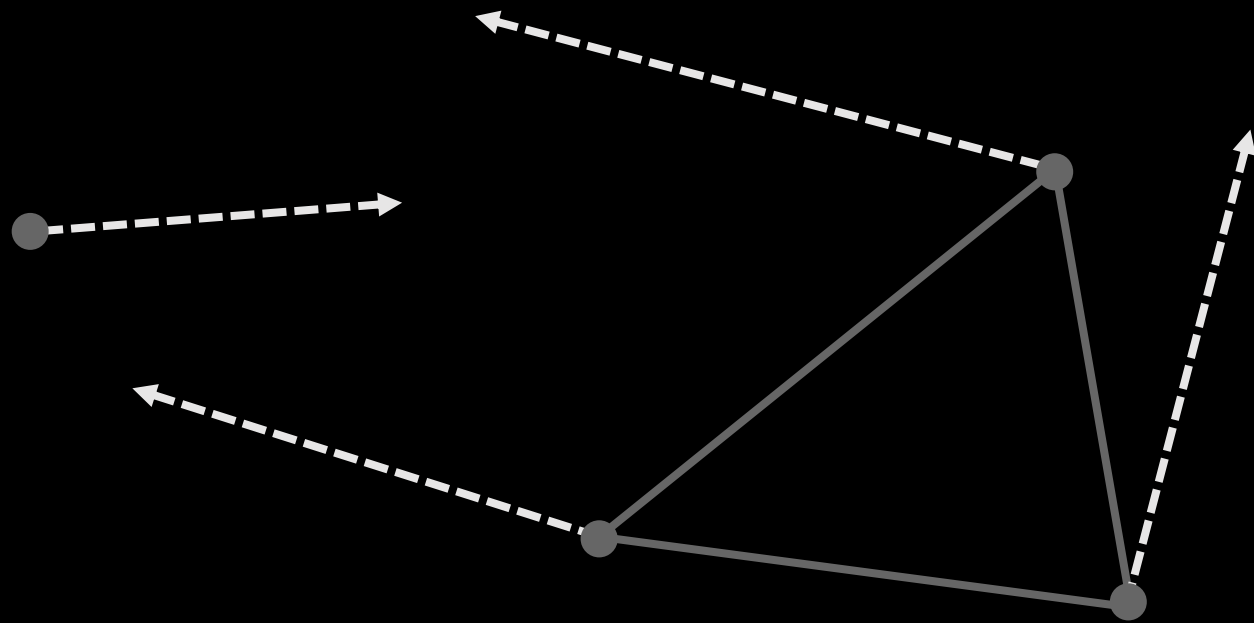
Point-Triangle



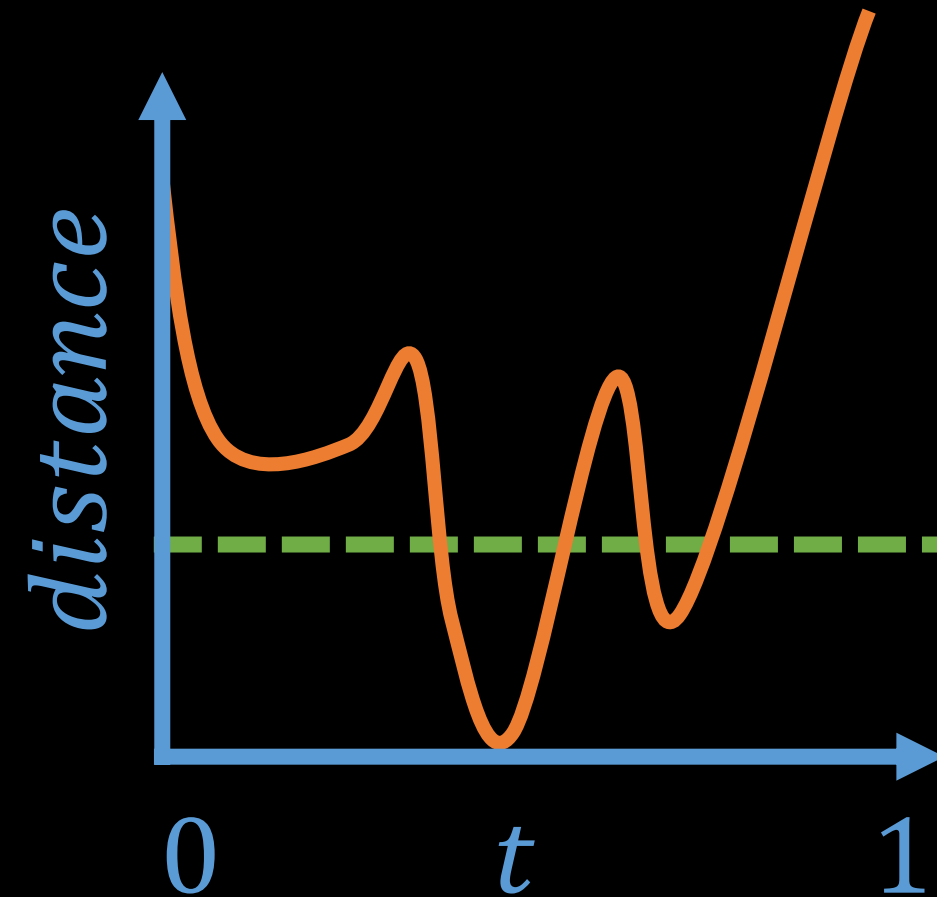
Time of Closest Separation: Sextic
Time of Impact: Cubic



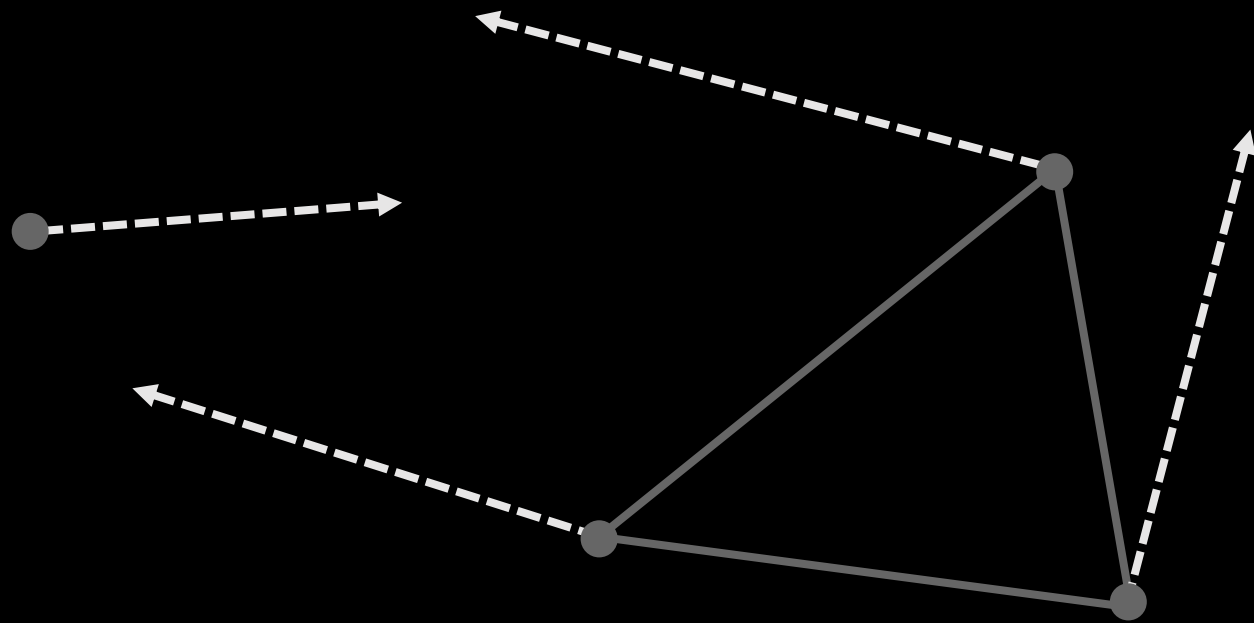
Point-Triangle



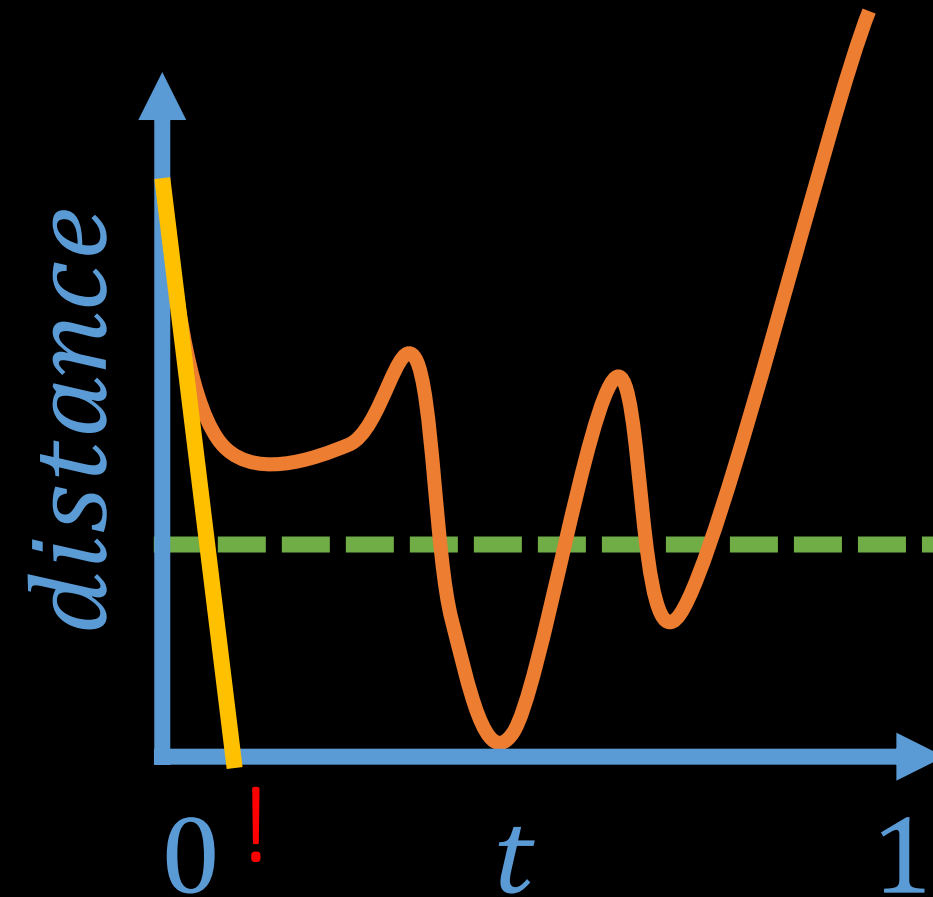
Time of Closest Separation: Sextic
Time of Impact: Cubic



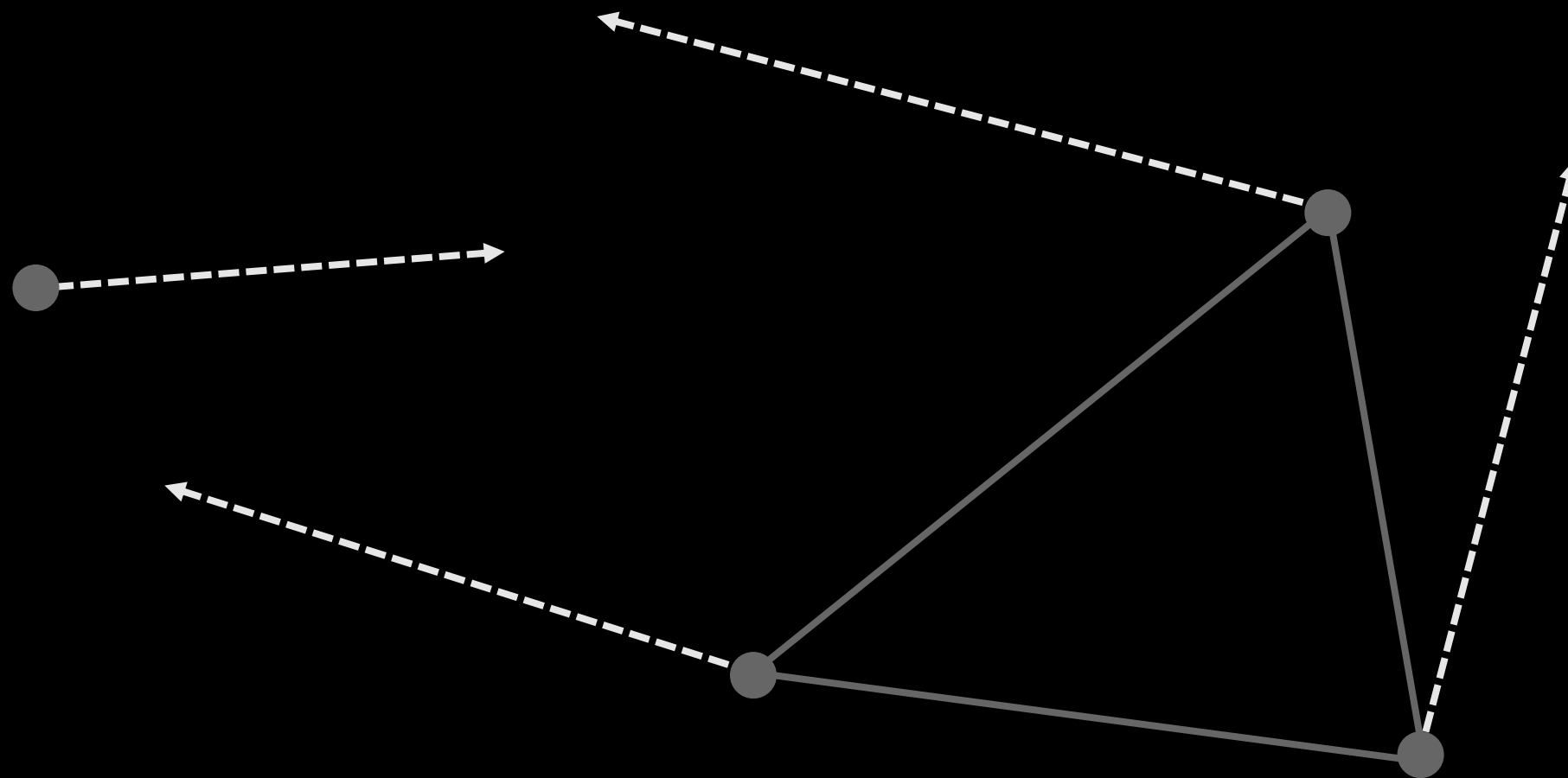
Point-Triangle



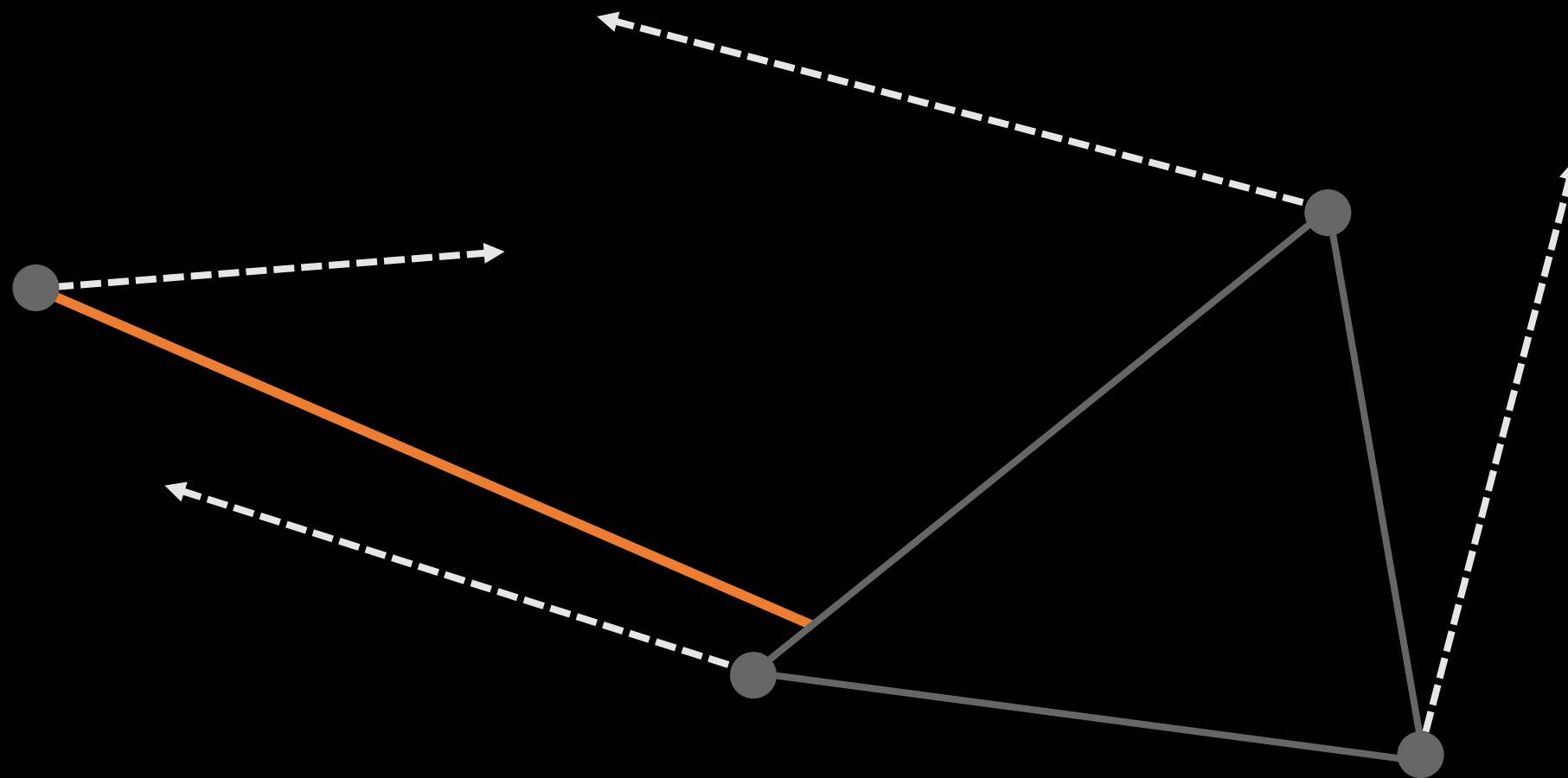
Time of Closest Separation:	Sextic
Time of Impact:	Cubic
Dynamic Collision Radius:	Linear



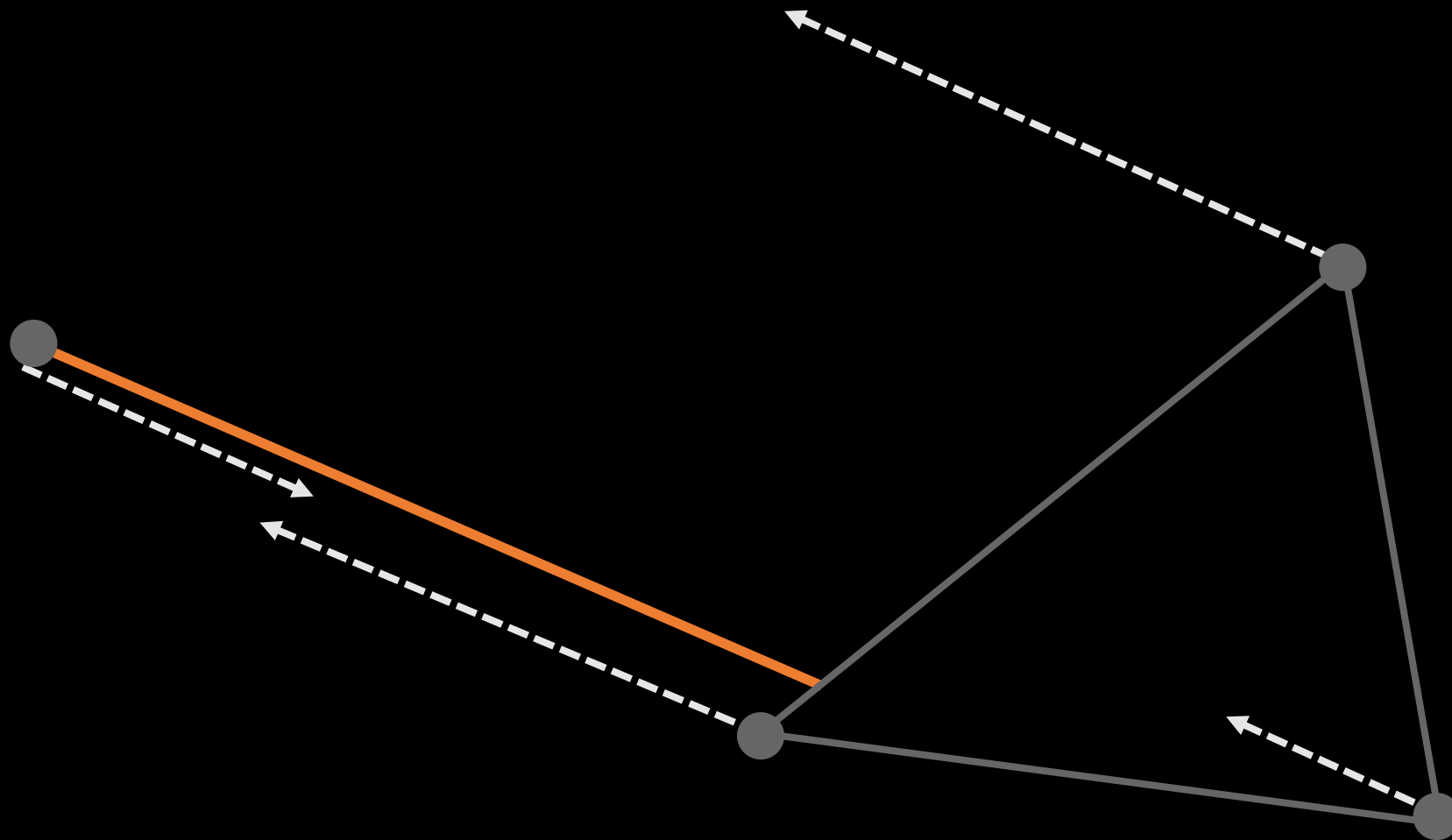
Point-Triangle



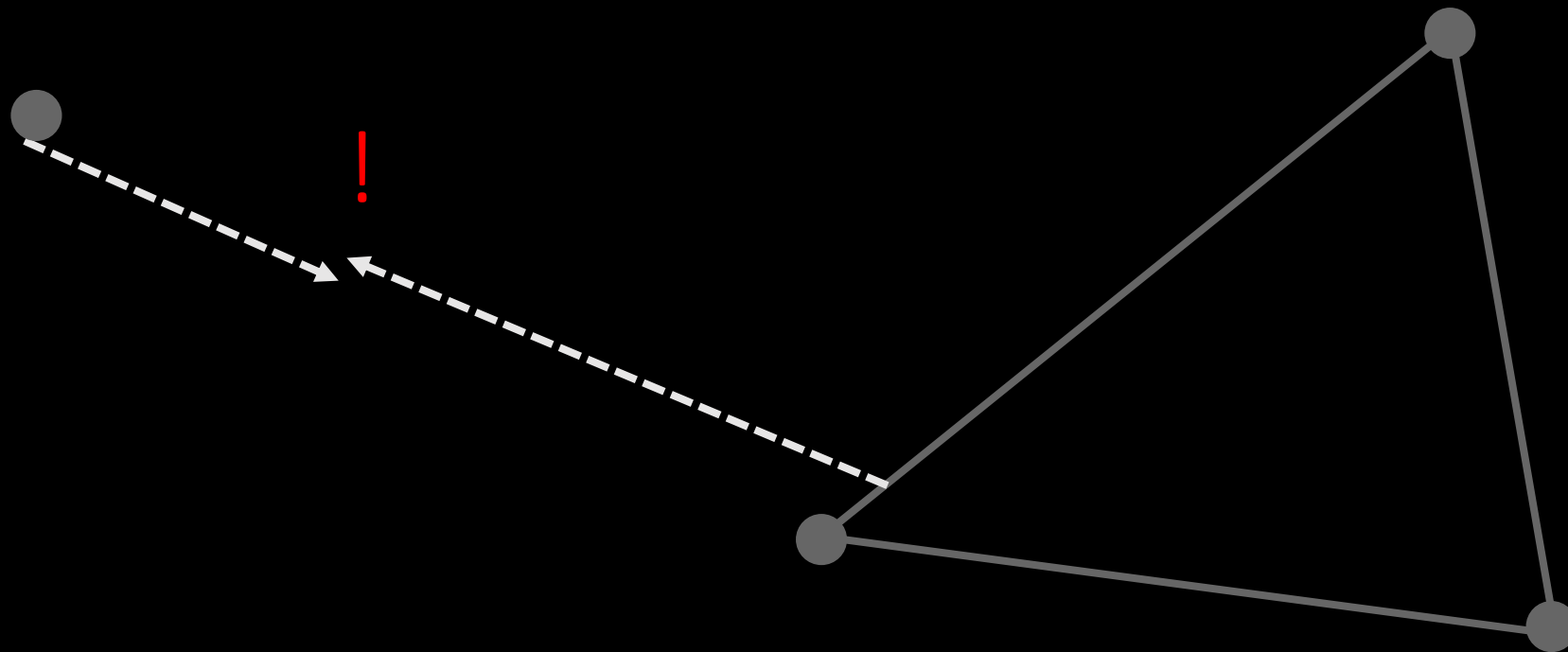
Point-Triangle



Point-Triangle

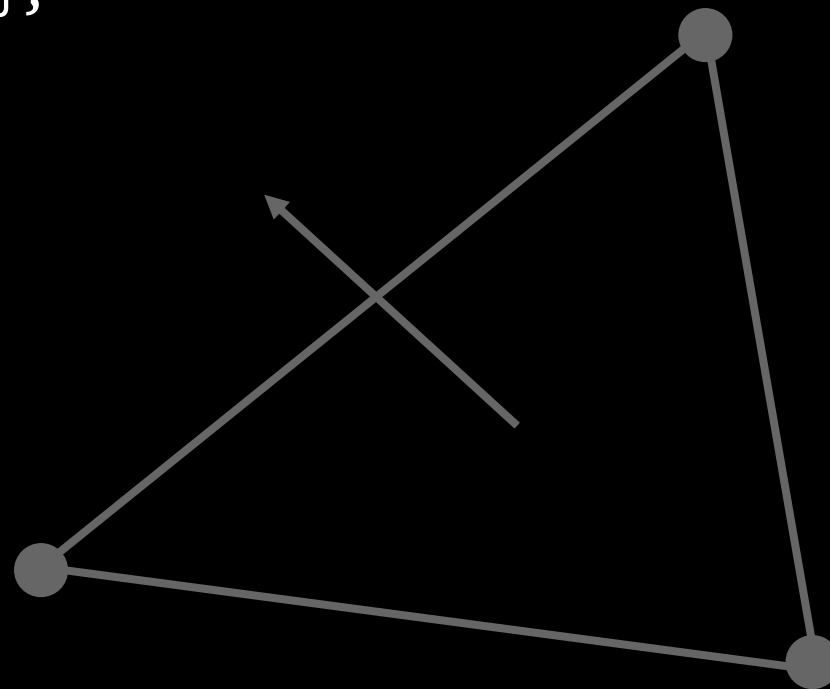


Point-Triangle

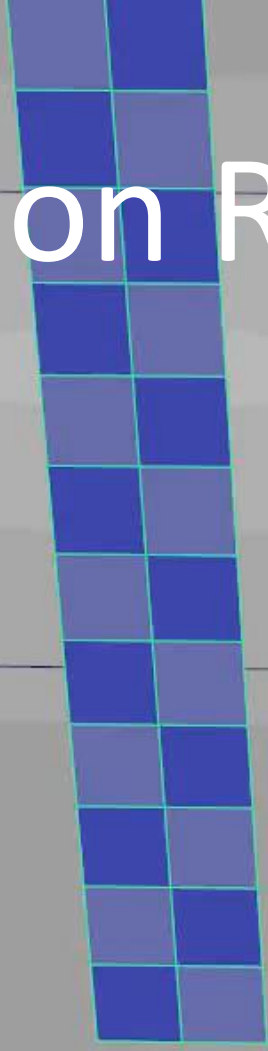


Point-Triangle

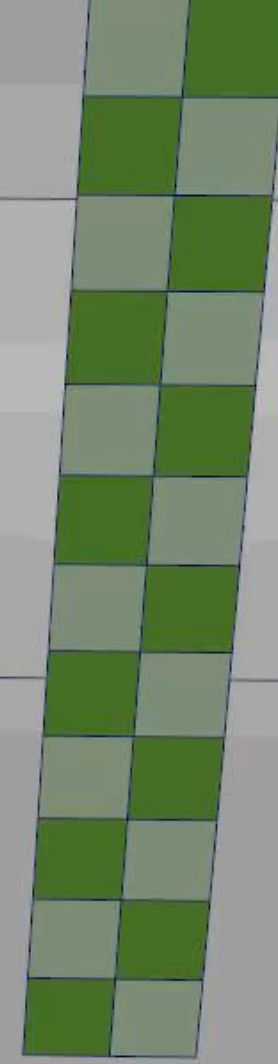
```
// Describes a contact between a cloth point and cloth
// triangle, for self collision.
struct PointTriangleContactDesc
{
    // Index of the point
    uint16_t pointIndex;
    // Index of the triangle.
    uint16_t triangleIndex : 15;
    // Which side of the
    // triangle the point started the frame on.
    uint16_t isBackFace : 1;
};
```



Dynamic Collision Radius



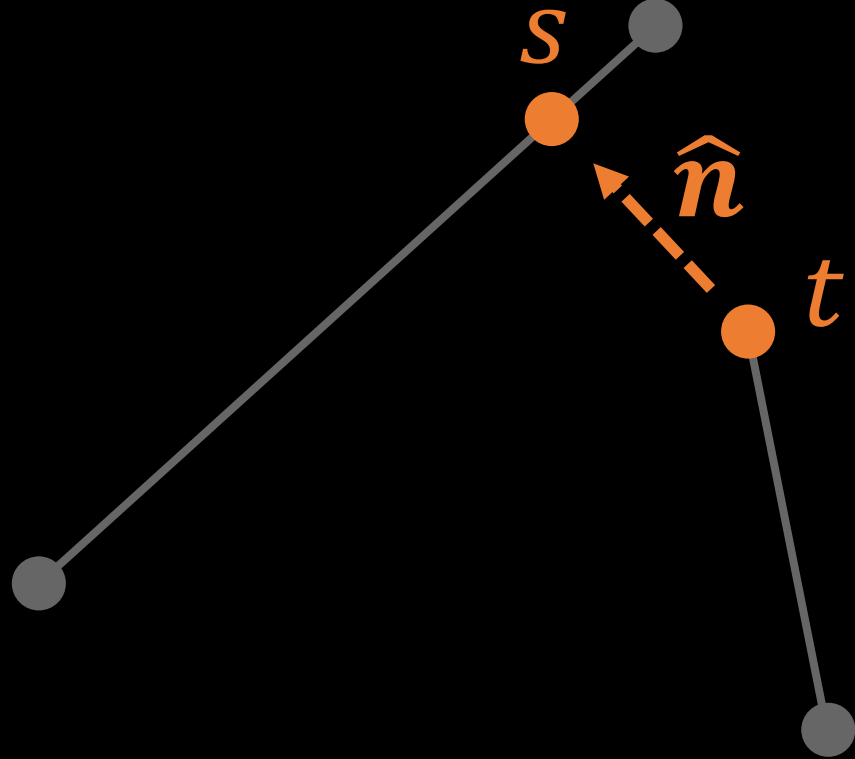
ON



OFF

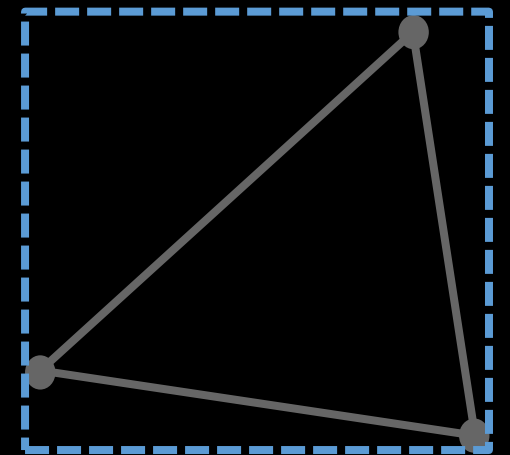
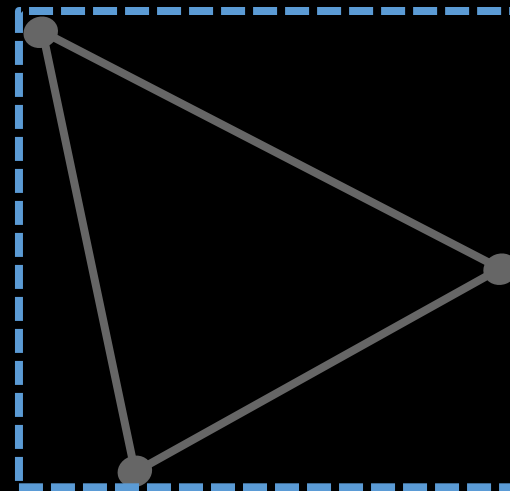
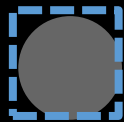


Edge-Edge

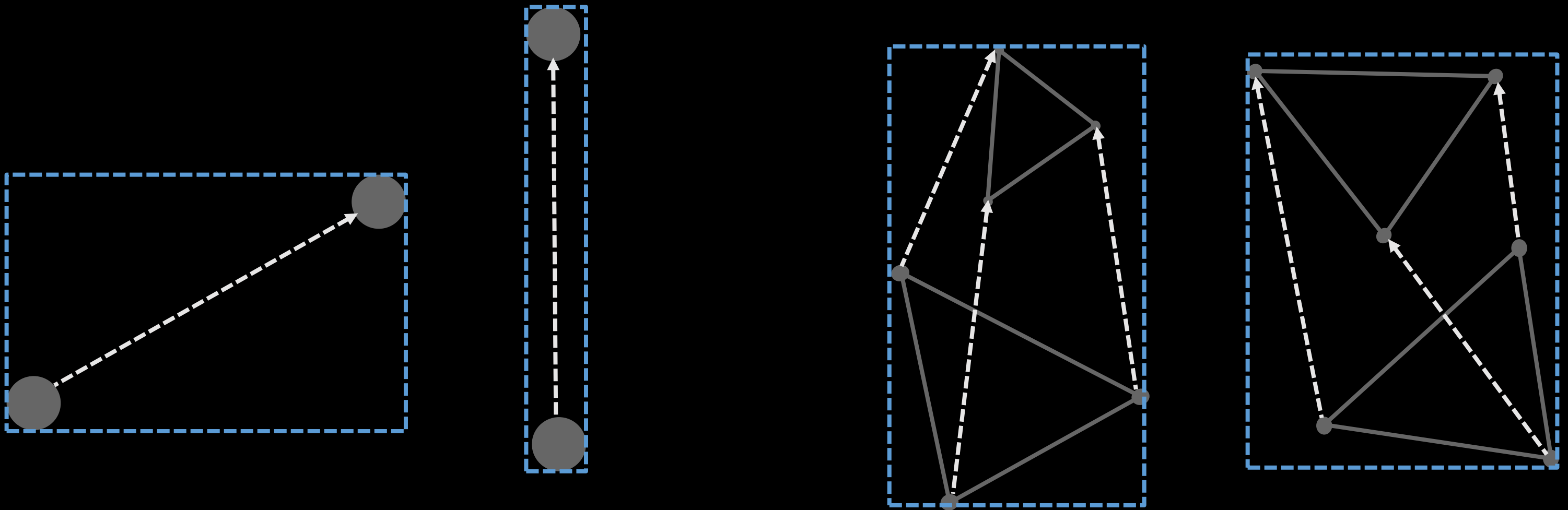


```
// Describes a contact between two edges of the cloth mesh,  
// for self collision.  
struct EdgeEdgeContactDesc  
{  
    // Offset normal between closest points on the two lines  
    Vector3 normal;  
    // parameter of closest point on line 0  
    float s;  
    // parameter of closest point on line 1  
    float t;  
    // Index of the 0th point on line 0  
    uint16_t e0p0;  
    // Index of the 1st point on line 0  
    uint16_t e0p1;  
    // Index of the 0th point on line 1  
    uint16_t e1p0;  
    // Index of the 1st point on line 1  
    uint16_t e1p1;  
};
```

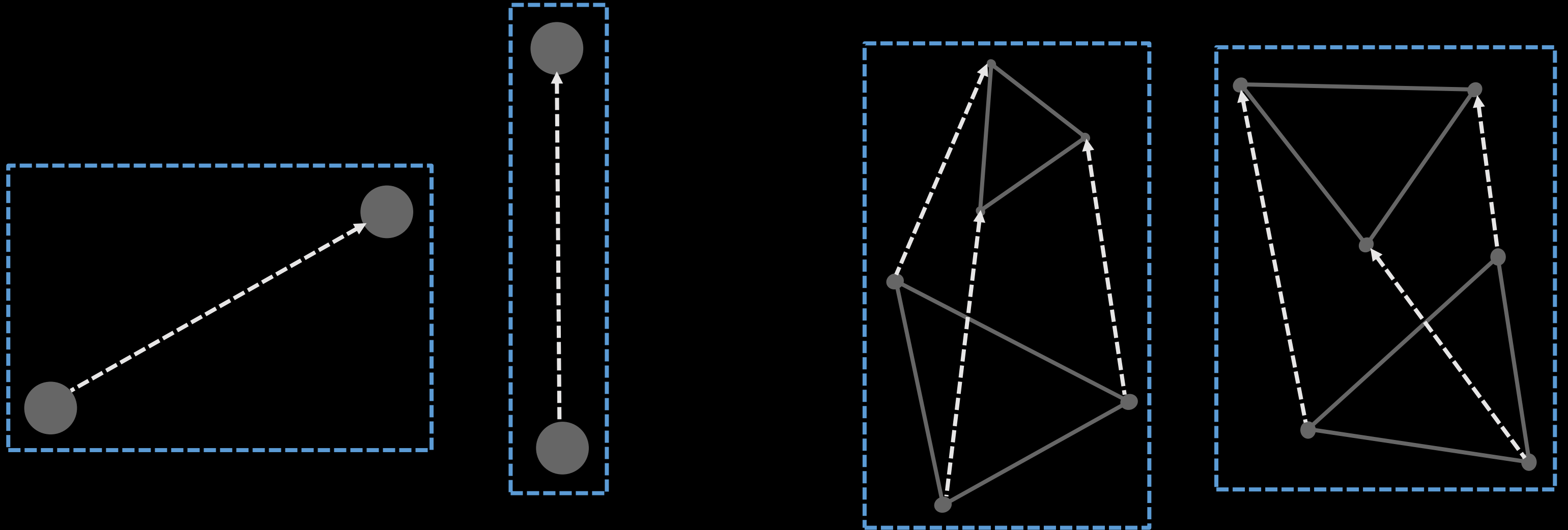

Broadphase



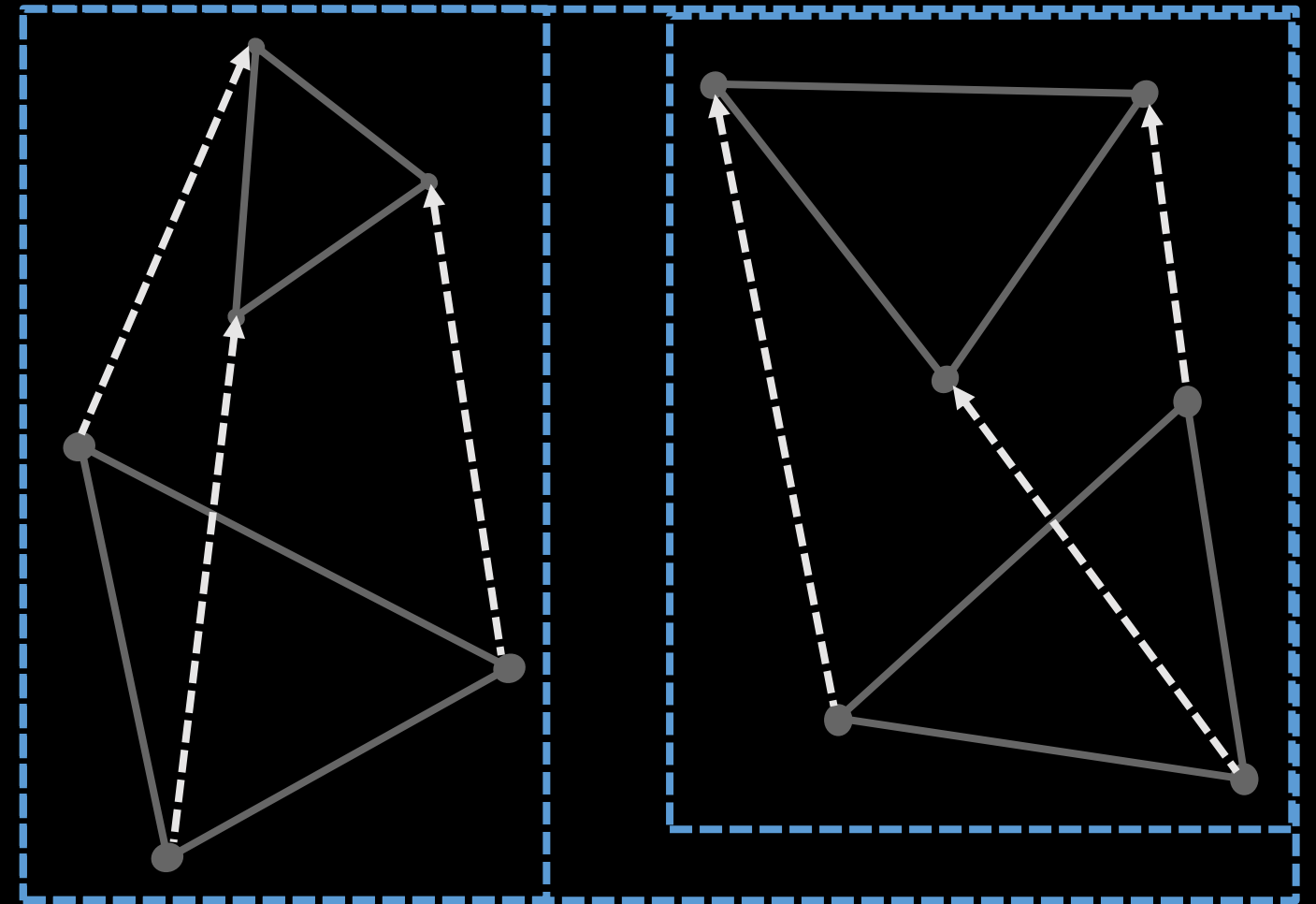
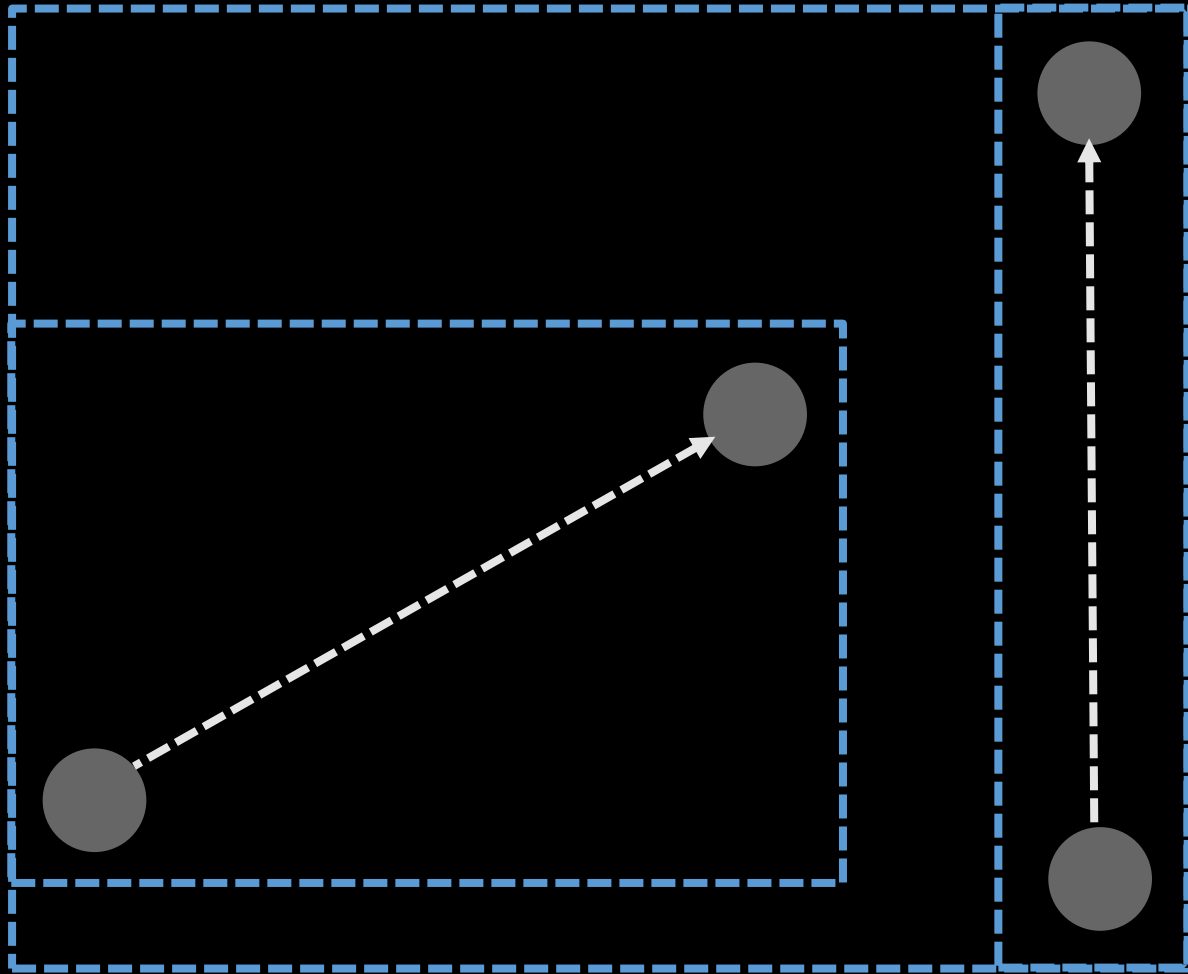
Broadphase



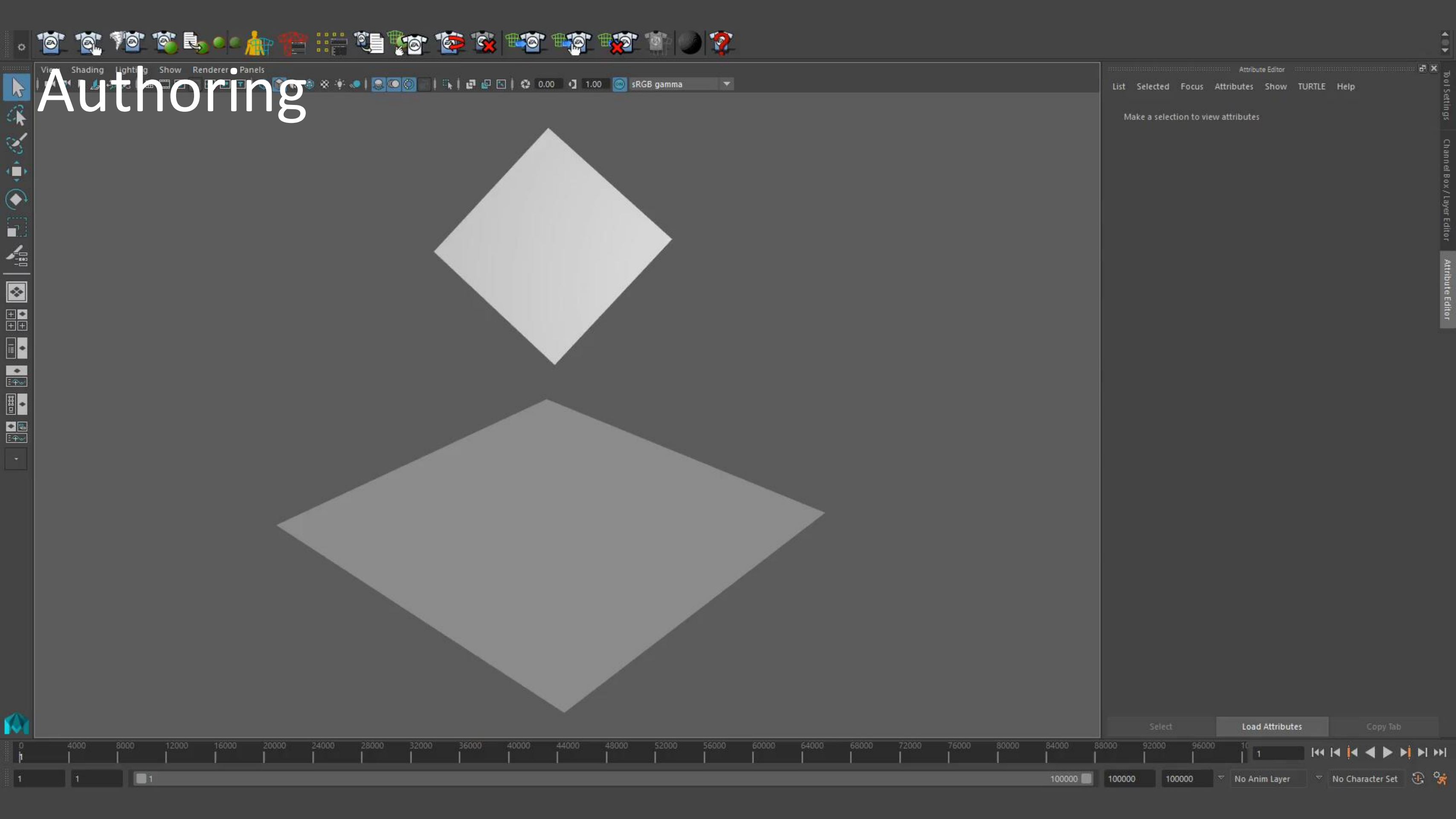
Broadphase



Broadphase



Authoring



Results



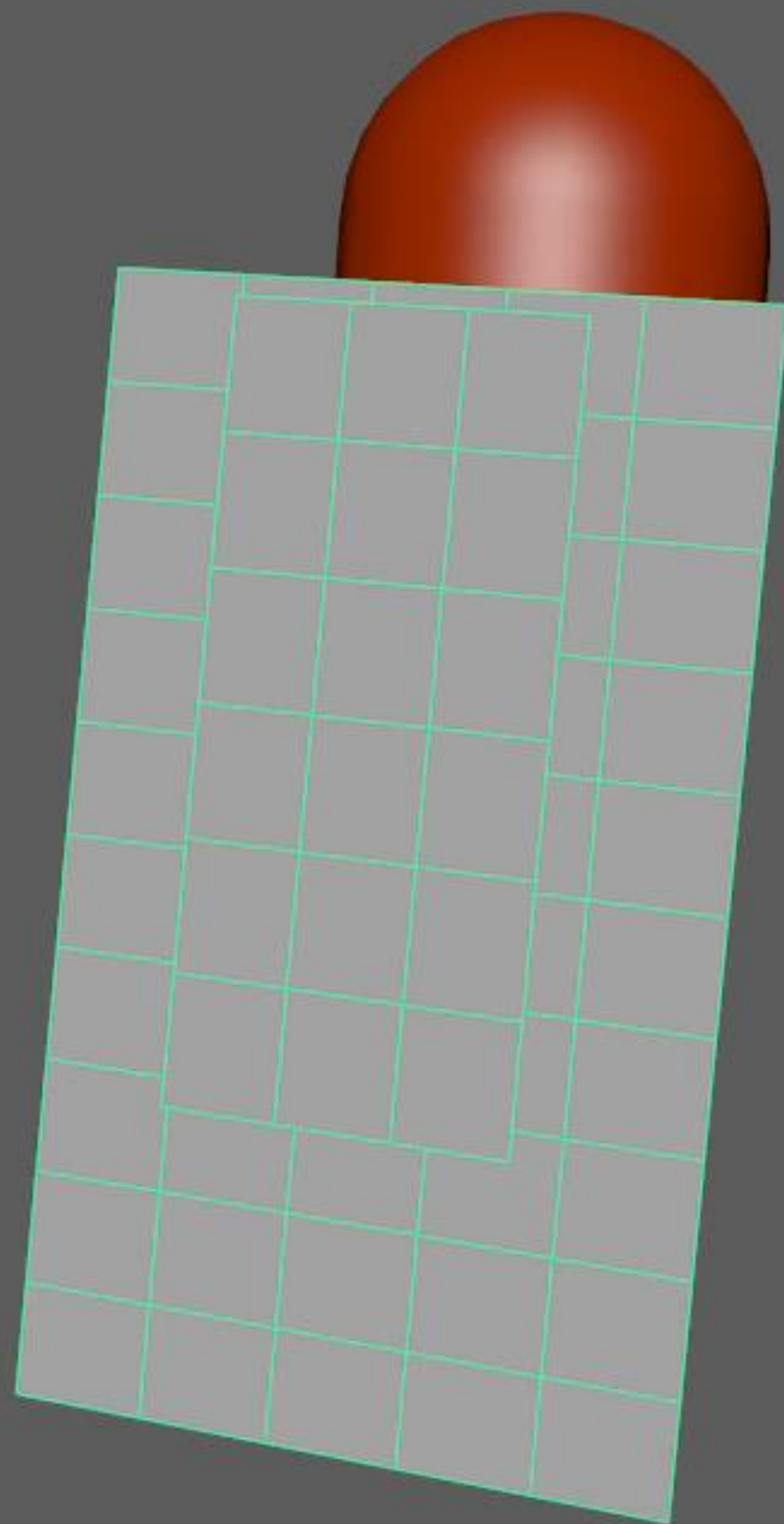
Triangle Collision
1.8k triangles
~20ms / frame
30Hz simulation
1 thread

Results

Triangle Collision
28k triangles
~1s / frame
60Hz simulation
1 thread

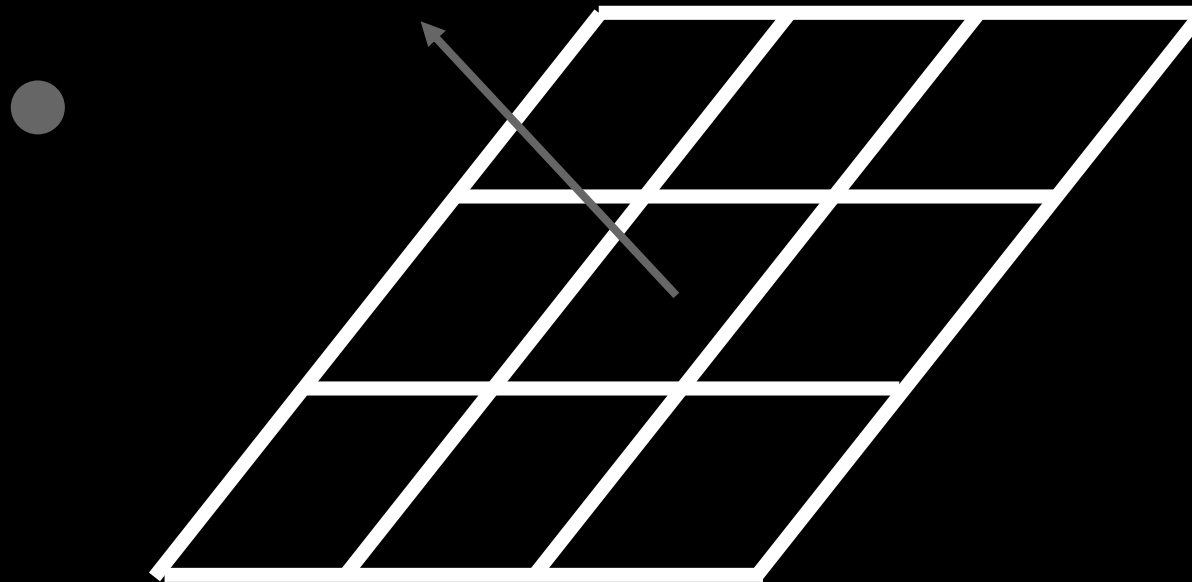


Results

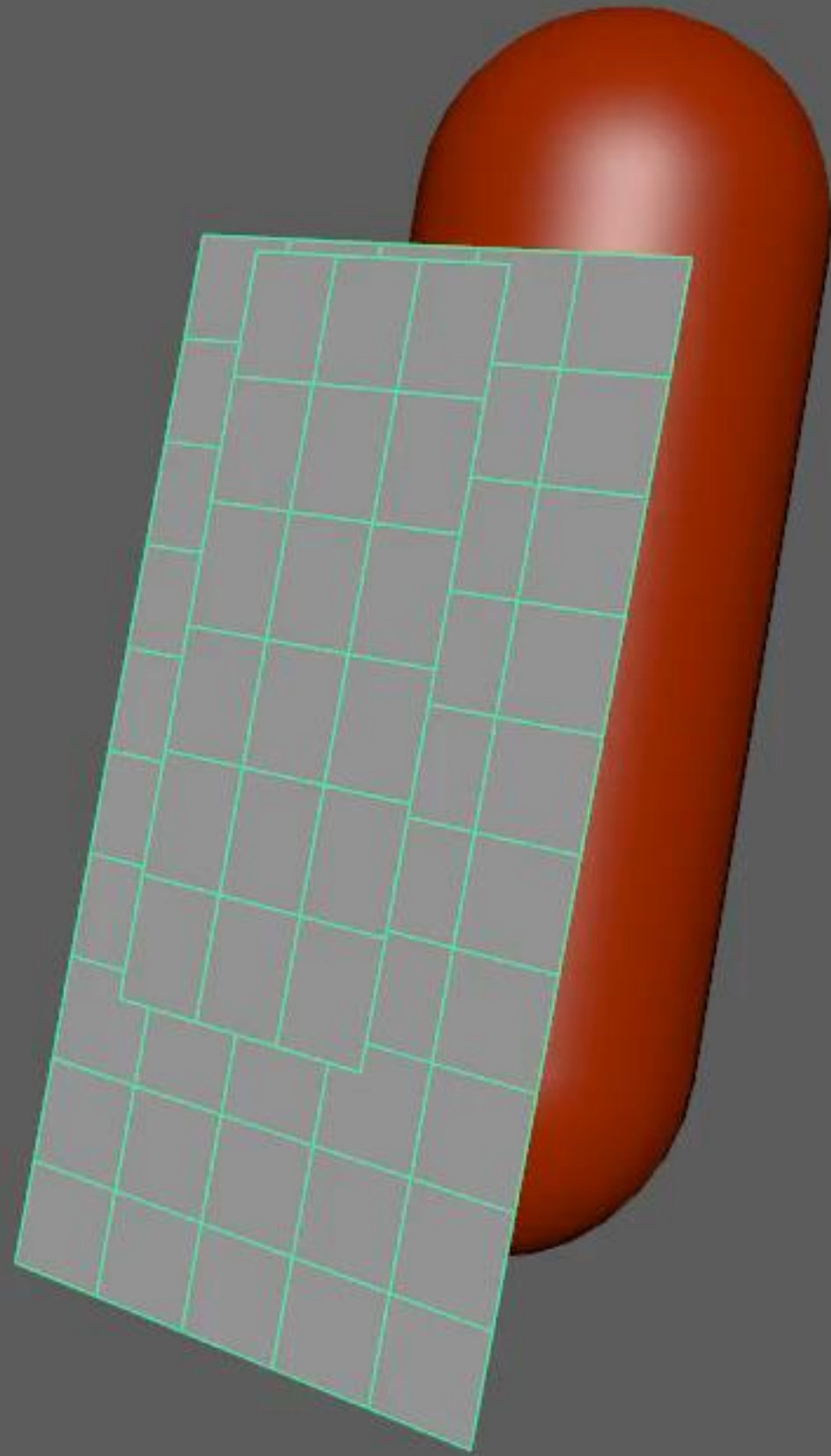


Dirty Tricks - Layered Clothing

Sometimes the surface has a natural orientation.

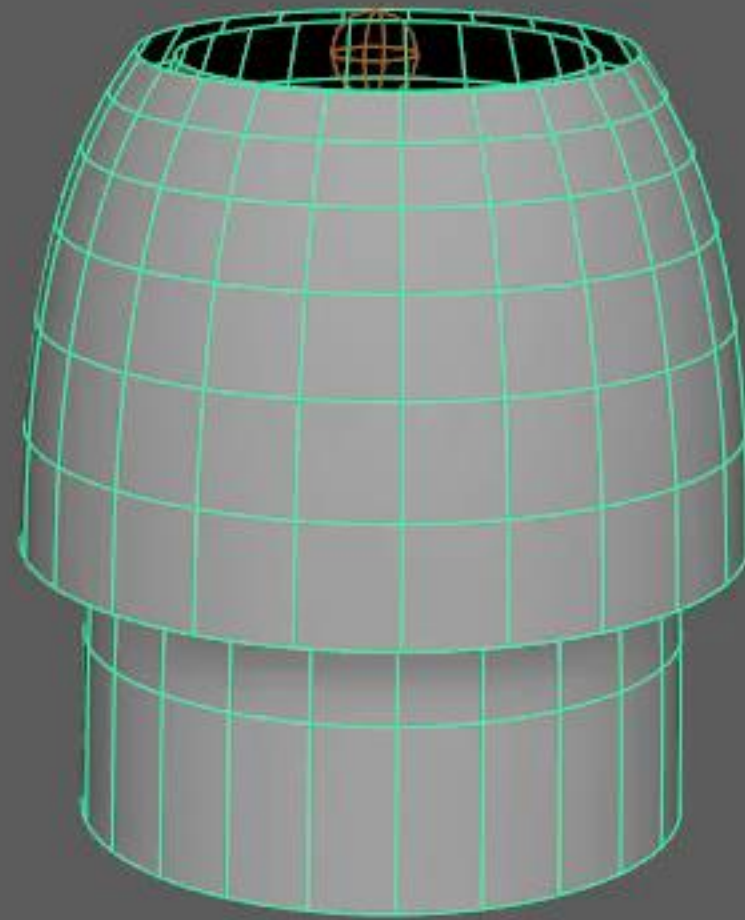


Results



Triangle Collision
0.2ms / frame
60Hz simulation
1 thread

Results

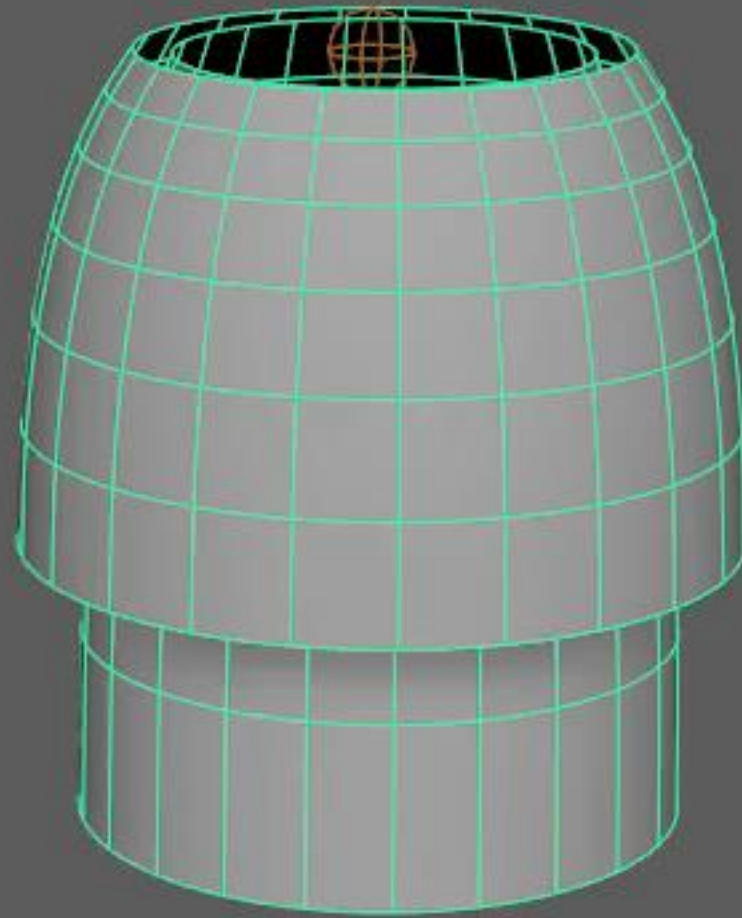


Triangle Collision
3ms / frame
30Hz simulation
1 thread

Dirty Tricks – Contact Caching

What if we only do the collision detection once?
Just keep the same contact set every frame

Contact Caching



3ms / frame -> 0.2ms / frame!



Performance in this example

380µs Total solve

60 µs Collision (points vs. colliders)

150µs Self-collision constraints

150µs All other constraints

Intel desktop CPU @ 2.8GHz

Single thread

Self collision is not vectorised: potential ~3x cost savings

Further quality / performance tradeoffs are possible



Issues and Future Work

Performance left on the table

-> SIMD for self collision

Contact Caching is naïve

-> Artist should be able to author contacts?

No viable solution for non-layered clothing

-> True CCD, and GPU

Thank You

Acknowledgements

Arvid Burstrom

Tom Waterson

Paddy O'Brien

Robin Taillandier

Harry Steggles

Frostbite.Team.Physics

Frostbite Physics is hiring!

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clewin@ea.com

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